

IELTS Academic Preparation

Your English notebook for the whole course. Know the test, build the skills for all four papers, practice under exam conditions, and track your band progress.

4 modules • 12 lessons

Words • grammar • speaking • I can...

Name: _____

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The Test & Foundations

Four classes to give you a clear map and a strong start. Find out exactly how IELTS Academic works and how it is scored, set a realistic target, and build a study plan around it. Then build two foundations that help in every part of the test: paraphrasing (saying the same idea in different words) and grammar that shows range and control.

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C4

Target 6.0-7.5

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Write, Listen, Say, Read, Timed** or **With a partner**. In **Timed** tasks, work to the clock and then mark your own answers honestly: that is how you learn where your marks go.

Your scores are private. You never have to share a score, your reasons for taking IELTS or personal information. When a task asks about you, use your real life, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent. All three are equally good.

◆ READ — THE COURSE MAP

Week 1	C1 Welcome and diagnostic · C2 Lesson 1.1 The test, the bands and your plan
Week 2	C3 Lesson 1.2 Vocabulary and paraphrasing · C4 Lesson 1.3 Grammar for a high band
Weeks 3–4	C5–C7 Module 2: Listening and Reading · C8 Practice Test 1 (timed Listening and Reading)
Weeks 5–6	C9–C11 Module 3: Academic Writing (Task 1 and Task 2)
Weeks 7–8	C12–C14 Module 4: Speaking and test strategy · C15–C16 Practice Test 2 (all four skills) and celebration

Homework is the matching **online lesson** (with Listen buttons, so you can hear every model sentence) plus a page of this workbook.

◆ READ AND SIGN — OUR COURSE CONTRACT

Your teacher promises:

- ◆ Your scores are private. They will never be shared or compared.
- ◆ You will get honest information about where you are and what will help most.
- ◆ Every practice test is practice: information for us, not a judgment of you.
- ◆ You never have to share personal information to take part.

I will try to:

- ◆ ☐ do the online lesson and the workbook page before the next class
- ◆ ☐ work to the clock in timed practice, even when it feels hard
- ◆ ☐ mark my own work honestly, so I know what to practice
- ◆ ☐ tell my teacher if I miss a class, and catch up with the online lesson
- ◆ ☐ help my classmates: we correct ideas and language, never people

Our class agreements (we decide these together):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Signed: _____ Date: _____

◆ READ – ABOUT TODAY'S DIAGNOSTIC

The diagnostic has four short parts: a **Listening** section, a **Reading** section, a **writing sample** and a **3-minute speaking sample** with your teacher. It is a **map, not a verdict**. Most people score a little lower today than they will in two weeks, because they haven't learned the format yet. Your results come back privately: Listening and Reading in C2, writing and speaking by C4.

Before each part: feet flat · breathe in for four · hold for two · breathe out for six · read the first instruction.

◆ WRITE – MY TARGET

I need IELTS for (optional): ☐ study ☐ work ☐ professional registration ☐ other ☐ I prefer not to say

Required overall band: _____ No skill below: _____

Or per skill: Listening _____ Reading _____ Writing _____ Speaking _____

My test date (real or provisional): _____ Weeks from today: _____

How confident do I feel today? (1 = not at all · 4 = very)

Listening	1 2 3 4	Reading	1 2 3 4
Writing	1 2 3 4	Speaking	1 2 3 4

◆ WRITE – MY BAND TRACKER (PRIVATE)

Write your results here each time. Diagnostic results are **estimates**. After each one, write your next focus.

	L	R	W	S	Overall	My next focus
My target						
Diagnostic (C1)						
Practice Test 1 (C8)			—	—	—	
Practice Test 2 (C15–C16)						
Error density (C4)	In my diagnostic writing: _____ error-free sentences out of _____					

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

How did the diagnostic feel? What was hardest: the language, the time, or the instructions?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY VOCABULARY

a band score	the overall band	a sub-score	a per-skill minimum
a raw score (out of 40)	transfer time	a word limit	a cue card
an examiner	Academic / General Training	to round up / down	to prioritize

per-skill minimum = the lowest band you may have in any one skill (for example, "no band below 6.0") ·

transfer time = extra minutes to copy answers onto the answer sheet · **to prioritize** = to put first

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — THE TEST MAP

Listening	about 30 min · 4 recordings · 40 questions	You hear each recording once .
Reading	60 min · 3 long passages · 40 questions	No extra transfer time: about 20 min per passage.
Writing	60 min · Task 1: describe a graph, chart, table, map or process (150+ words) · Task 2: an essay (250+ words)	Task 2 counts twice as much: about 20 + 40 min.
Speaking	11–14 min · Part 1 interview · Part 2 talk from a cue card (1 min to prepare, up to 2 min to speak) · Part 3 discussion	Always with a real examiner .

The overall band = the average of the four skills, rounded to the **nearest half band**.

Average ends in...	.0 / .5 → stays	.125 → down (6.125 → 6.0)	.25 → up to .5 (6.25 → 6.5)	.375 → up (6.375 → 6.5)	.625 → down (6.625 → 6.5)	.75 → up to the next whole band (6.75 → 7.0)
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Say scores like this: "six point five" or "six and a half." Not: "six comma five."

Three strategic principles: 1. Manage the clock: a hard question is worth one mark, the same as an easy one. 2. Never leave a blank: there is no penalty for a wrong answer. 3. Answer exactly what was asked: "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS" means a three-word answer scores zero.

◆ LISTEN — EXERCISE 1: THE RESULTS CONVERSATION

Amal talks to an adviser about her practice-test results. Write her four bands, then calculate her overall band.

Listening _____ Reading _____ Writing _____ Speaking _____

Average _____ → Overall band _____

Her university needs an overall _____ with no band below _____. Which skill should she prioritize? _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – EXERCISE 2: COMPLETE THE TEST MAP

Your partner has the facts you don't have. Ask and answer. Don't show your card.

Section	Time	Parts / questions	What you do	One warning
Listening				
Reading				
Writing				
Speaking				

Useful questions: *How long is...? · How many questions / parts are there? · What do you have to do? · Is there anything to be careful about?*

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: BAND MATHS

Calculate the average and the overall band for each profile.

Profile	L	R	W	S	Average	Overall
1	6.0	6.0	5.5	6.0		
2	7.5	7.0	6.0	6.5		
3	6.5	7.0	6.0	6.0		
4	5.5	6.0	6.0	6.5		

Profile 3 needs "overall 6.5, no band below 6.5." Does it reach the target? _____. Which skills must improve? _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – EXERCISE 4: MYTH OR FACT?

After the card sort, write **M** (myth) or **F** (fact).

1. IELTS is pass or fail. _____
2. A wrong answer in Listening or Reading loses you a mark. _____
3. Spelling counts in Listening and Reading answers. _____
4. The computer test is easier than the paper test. _____
5. Writing Task 2 is worth more than Task 1. _____
6. If you write fewer than 150 words (Task 1) or 250 words (Task 2), you can lose marks. _____

7. You need a British or American accent to get a high Speaking band. _____
8. Memorized answers are a good way to get a high Speaking band. _____
9. Using as many long, rare words as possible raises your band. _____
10. The examiner gives marks for having the "right" opinion in Task 2. _____
11. The overall band is the average of the four skills, rounded to the nearest half band. _____
12. A hyphenated word such as "well-known" counts as one word. _____

◆ TIMED (3 MINUTES) – EXERCISE 5: THE WORD-LIMIT DRILL

Read the notice. Complete the notes. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

RIVERSIDE COLLEGE — SUMMER STUDY CENTER

The Summer Study Center opens on June 3 in the north wing of the main library, next to the computer lab. From Monday to Thursday it is open from 8:30 a.m. to 9 p.m.; on Fridays it closes early, at 5 p.m. It is closed on weekends. Group study rooms hold up to six people and can be booked for a maximum of two hours a day at the information desk. Silent study is on the upper floor. Students must show a valid student card to enter. Laptops can be borrowed free of charge for up to four hours; a replacement charger costs \$12. Please note that food is not allowed, but drinks in closed bottles are welcome.

1. Location: the north wing of the _____
2. Closing time on Fridays: _____
3. Group rooms are booked at the _____
4. To enter, show a valid _____
5. Drinks must be in _____

Mark your answers. Right meaning but too many words = wrong. Wrong spelling = wrong. My score: _____ / 5. Did I lose any marks to the rule, not to English? _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: PLANNING FROM THE GAP

Mei: So what does your university need?

Tariq: Overall six point five, with no band below six.

Mei: And your diagnostic?

Tariq: About six overall. My Reading was fine, but Writing was around five and a half.

Mei: So Writing is below the minimum. That's your priority, isn't it?

Tariq: I know, but I enjoy Reading more. I was going to do a Reading test every day.

Mei: A great Reading score can't rescue a Writing score that's under the minimum. Why not put Writing first and keep one Reading test a week?

Tariq: Fair point. Two Task 2 essays a week, then, and one timed Reading passage.

Mei: And when is your test?

Tariq: In ten weeks. Half a band in Writing is realistic, I think. A full band would be a bonus.

Underline the target, the per-skill minimum and the priority. Why is Mei's advice good?

◆ WRITE – MY IELTS PLAN

My target (overall)		No skill below	
My test date		Weeks left	
Diagnostic estimate (overall)		My gap (target – now)	
My skills, strongest → weakest	1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____ 4. _____		
My priority skill (and why)			
My weekly commitment (with numbers)			
If a week goes wrong, I will...			

◆ WITH A PARTNER – THE STUDY-PLAN INTERVIEW

Interview your partner. Use your real plan or a new identity card. At the end, give **one suggestion** with "because."

1. What band do you need, and is there a minimum for each skill? · 2. When is your test, and how many weeks do you have? · 3. Which skill is your strongest? Your weakest? · 4. What will you do every week? How many hours? · 5. What usually stops you studying, and what will you do about it?

Suggestion: "You could... because..." · "Why not...? That way..." · "Have you thought about...?"

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A completion question says "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS." You write a correct three-word answer. What do you score?

A) Full marks

B) Half a mark

C) Zero

2

Your bands are L 6.0, R 6.5, W 6.0, S 7.0. What is your overall band?

A) 6.5

B) 6.0

C) 7.0

3

Which statement about IELTS Writing is true?

A) Task 1 and Task 2 carry equal weight, so give each 30 minutes.

B) Task 2 carries more weight than Task 1, so give it about 40 minutes.

C) If your grammar is excellent, you can write fewer words.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ describe the four sections of IELTS Academic and their timing
- ◆ ☐ calculate an overall band with the rounding rule
- ◆ ☐ tell facts from myths about how IELTS is scored
- ◆ ☐ follow a word limit exactly, even under time pressure
- ◆ ☐ write a study plan that puts my weakest skill first

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write your target, test date and weakest skill at the top. Then: what is the biggest obstacle between you

and your target, and what will you do about it this week?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY VOCABULARY

to paraphrase	a synonym	a general word	word class
a word family	a collocation	register	a trap (distractor)
meaning drift	Lexical Resource	the Academic Word List	to restate

collocation = words that naturally go together (*make a mistake*, not *do a mistake*) · **meaning drift** = your paraphrase has accidentally changed the meaning · **Lexical Resource** = the vocabulary criterion in Writing and Speaking (one quarter of the mark)

Academic chunks:

contribute to	give rise to	have a detrimental effect on	play a significant role in
a growing number of	a considerable amount of	to a large extent	it is widely believed that
address the issue of			

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — THE PARAPHRASE LADDER

Base sentence: *Young people pollute the air when they drive cars.* Climb **at least two rungs**.

5 · General word	cars → private transport · apples and pears → fruit
4 · Structure	when they drive → by driving · Although... → ...; however, ...
3 · Voice	drivers cause pollution → pollution is caused by drivers
2 · Word class	pollute (verb) → pollution (noun) · decide → make a decision
1 · Synonym	young people → adolescents · cars → vehicles

Result: *Adolescents contribute to air pollution through their use of vehicles.* (rungs 1, 2 and 4)

Two failures. Too little: one word swapped, same sentence. Too much: the meaning changes (*some* → *all*, *may* → *will*, *affordable* → *cheap*). Keep numbers, quantities and hedges exactly.

Word families. The sentence decides the form. Listen for the stress: it often moves.

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
------	------	-----------	--------

ANalyze	aNALysis	anaLYTical	anaLYTically
conTRIBute	contriBUTION	—	—
—	eCONomy	ecoNOMIC (about the economy) · ecoNOMical (cheap to run)	ecoNOMICally
reQUIRE	reQUIREment	reQUIRED	—

Upgrade, with a partner word: get → *acquire* skills · big → *a substantial* increase · show → *the graph illustrates* · bad for → *have a detrimental effect on* · cause → *give rise to* · help → *facilitate* communication. Only use an academic word when you know its partners.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THE WORKSHOP REGISTRATION

A student phones to register for a study-skills workshop. Complete the form. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER**. You will hear the call **once**.

Workshop	Note-taking for Lectures
Day	1 _____
Start time	2 _____
Place	3 _____, Harper Building
Bring	4 _____
Student fee	5 _____
Family name	6 _____

Second listening: what was the **trap** for each answer? Write one: _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: WORD FAMILIES

Complete the table. Then complete the sentences with the right form.

Verb	Noun	Adjective	Adverb
analyze	_____	_____	analytically
_____	benefit	_____	beneficially
vary	_____	various / variable	—
_____	significance	significant	_____
sustain	_____	_____	sustainably

1. The _____ of the survey data took three weeks.

2. Regular exercise is highly _____ for mental health.
3. There is considerable _____ in rents between neighborhoods.
4. The number of cyclists rose _____ after the new lanes opened.
5. Small cars are usually more _____ to run than large ones.
6. Many cities now invest in _____ transport, such as electric buses.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: CLIMB THE LADDER

Paraphrase each sentence using the rungs in brackets. Keep the meaning exactly.

1. The city built more bike lanes, and fewer people drove to work. (word class + structure)
→ _____
2. Many parents worry about how much time children spend online. (synonym + word class)
→ _____
3. Scientists measured the air quality in twelve cities. (voice)
→ _____
4. Apples, oranges and bananas are cheaper at the market. (general word + synonym)
→ _____
5. "Most students prefer to study in the evening." Write it three ways. Keep "most."
a) _____
b) _____
c) _____

◆ TIMED (8 MINUTES) – EXERCISE 4: GARDENS ON THE ROOF

READ THE PASSAGE

A In many dense cities, flat roofs are among the few spaces left unused. Over the past fifteen years, a growing number of building owners have covered them with soil and plants. Supporters argue that these "green roofs" can cool buildings, hold back rainwater and give insects a place to feed. Critics point out that the initial cost is high: a green roof can cost two to three times as much as a conventional one to install.

B The cooling effect is the best documented benefit. On a summer afternoon, a dark conventional roof can become far hotter than the air around it, while a planted roof usually stays close to air temperature, because water evaporating from leaves and soil carries heat away. The top floors of buildings with green roofs therefore tend to need less air conditioning, although the effect on lower floors is small.

C Rainwater is the second major benefit. A planted roof acts like a sponge, holding part of a storm's rain and releasing it slowly. In one three-year study of a city office block, the roof retained roughly half of the rain that fell on it over a year, though far less during the heaviest storms, when the soil was already full.

D The benefit for wildlife is harder to measure. Surveys have recorded bees and beetles on many roofs, but researchers caution that a roof planted with a single type of low-growing plant offers little food. Roofs with a mix of native flowering species attract a wider variety of insects. Whether green roofs can replace lost habitat at ground level remains an open question.

Questions 1–3. Which paragraph, A–D, contains the following information?

1. evidence that a benefit is reduced in extreme weather _____
2. a reason why some people are against green roofs _____
3. a suggestion that the choice of plants affects the result _____

Questions 4–6. Circle A, B or C.

4. According to paragraph A, installing a green roof...

A) costs the same as a conventional roof over fifteen years. B) is considerably more expensive than installing an ordinary roof. C) is three times cheaper than many people think.

5. What does the writer say about the cooling effect?

A) It is equally strong on every floor of the building. B) It is supported by more evidence than the other benefits. C) It works because the plants block the air.

6. In the office-block study, the roof...

A) held all the rain from the heaviest storms. B) released rainwater quickly. C) kept around 50 percent of the year's rainfall.

Mark your answers. My score: _____ / 6. For each wrong answer, write the word that tricked me:

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: UPGRADE WITH THE RIGHT PARTNER

Circle the word that collocates naturally.

1. Smoking has a (detrimental / substantial) effect on health.
2. There has been a (substantial / detrimental) increase in online shopping.
3. On the course, students (acquire / obtain) practical skills.
4. A poor diet can (give rise to / facilitate) a range of illnesses.
5. The graph (illustrates / maintains) a clear upward trend.
6. A (considerable / detrimental) amount of research has been done on sleep.

Now upgrade these two sentences. Keep the collocation natural.

7. Noise from traffic is bad for people's sleep.

→ _____

8. Video calls help people who work in different countries talk to each other.

→ _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: CHECKING A PARAPHRASE

Ana: Can you check my introduction? The prompt says, "Some people think that all university courses should be free."

Ben: Sure. What did you write?

Ana: "Everybody believes that university education must cost nothing."

Ben: Good changes of words, but the meaning has drifted. The prompt says "some people," not "everybody."

Ana: Oh, right. And "should" isn't "must," is it?

Ben: Exactly. "Must" is much stronger. How about "It is sometimes argued that higher education ought to be free of charge"?

Ana: That's better. "Some people think" becomes "it is sometimes argued," and "university courses" becomes "higher education."

Ben: Two rungs at least: a synonym and a change of structure. And nothing copied.

Underline the two drift errors in Ana's first version. Which rungs does Ben's version climb?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PARAPHRASE RELAY AND NO-ECHO

Round 1. Your partner reads a Task 2-style prompt. You have 30 seconds to think, then restate it in one or two sentences. Don't repeat the "don't repeat" words on the card.

It is sometimes argued that...

Many people believe that...

There is some debate about whether...

In recent years, ... has become...

This essay will argue that...

Round 2. Your partner is the examiner and asks Part 1 questions. Answer in 2–3 sentences without repeating the question's words.

My best introduction: _____

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A Reading question says "the factory increased its output." Which sentence in the text is the paraphrased answer?

A) "The factory scaled back what it produced."

B) "The plant's production rose over the period."

C) "The manager increased his output of emails."

2

Which is the best academic upgrade of "Technology helps people communicate"?

A) Technology assists to communicate people.

B) Technology facilitates communication.

C) Technology aids the communicating of people.

3

A question says "The number of visitors doubled." Which sentence in the passage matches it?

A) "Visitor numbers rose considerably."

B) "Twice as many people visited as in the previous year."

C) "The visitors doubled their spending."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ paraphrase a sentence by climbing at least two rungs of the ladder
- ◆ ☐ keep the meaning, numbers and hedges exactly when I paraphrase
- ◆ ☐ choose the right form from a word family, with the right stress
- ◆ ☐ use academic words only with their natural partners
- ◆ ☐ spot an answer that is worded differently, and reject a trap that only shares a word

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which rung of the ladder is hardest for you? What small thing will you do this week to practice it?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY VOCABULARY

Grammatical Range & Accuracy	range	accuracy	a clause
a subordinate clause	a relative clause	a conditional	a participle clause
a noun clause	a comma splice	an uncountable noun	error density

clause = a group of words with a subject and a verb · **comma splice** = two sentences joined only by a comma
 · **error density** = how many of your sentences contain errors (the fewer, the better)

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — RANGE AND ACCURACY

What the **grammar criterion rewards** (paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors):

Band	Range	Accuracy
5	mostly simple sentences; complex ones are rare	errors are frequent and can make reading difficult
6	a mix of simple and complex sentences	some errors, but the meaning stays clear
7	a variety of complex structures	many sentences have no errors at all
8	a wide range, used flexibly	most sentences are error-free; only occasional slips

From 5 to 6: add range. From 6 to 7: keep that range accurate.

The toolkit.

Subordinate clause	Although car use rose, bus use also increased. (Not: Although..., but...)
Relative clause	Students who work part-time... (defining, no commas) · The bridge, which opened in 1932, ... (non-defining, commas)
Conditionals	If cities invest in cycling, congestion will fall. · If fees were lower, more people would enroll. (Not: If it will continue)
Participle clause	Having doubled in a decade, the population then stabilized.

Noun clause	What is clear is that demand will keep growing. · The fact that... · One reason why... is that...
Comparison	Spending was far higher in 2020 than in any earlier year.

Tense by task. Task 1: read the dates first (2000–2015 → *rose* · 2012 to now → *has risen* · forecast → *is expected to rise*) · a process → present passive (*is heated*) · Task 2 → present simple for opinions, conditionals for possibilities.

The band-limiting seven: articles · subject–verb agreement (*The number of students **is***) · prepositions (*an increase **in**, responsible **for**, an effect **on***) · comma splices · uncountables (*information, advice, research*) · word form (*affect* = verb, *effect* = noun) · one structure on repeat.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THREE ANSWERS

Three candidates answer the same Part 3 question: "Why do you think more people are choosing to live in cities?" Tick the structures you hear.

	Candidate A	Candidate B	Candidate C
subordinate clause			
relative clause			
conditional			
comparative			
errors that blur the meaning?			

Which answer shows range **and** control? _____ Why? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: COMBINE INTO ONE SENTENCE

Use the structure in brackets.

1. Public libraries are free. Many people do not use them. (although)

→ _____

2. Some employees work from home. They often save time. (defining relative clause)

→ _____

3. The museum is in the city center. It attracts two million visitors a year. (non-defining relative clause)

→ _____

4. Fees are high. Fewer students enroll. (second conditional: If fees...)

→ _____

5. Car sales doubled in a decade. Then they fell sharply. (participle clause: Having...)

→ _____

◆ TIMED (3 MINUTES) – EXERCISE 3: TENSE BY TASK

Write the verb in the correct form.

1. (Task 1, a chart for 2000–2015) The number of cyclists _____ (double) over the period.
2. (Task 1, a chart from 2012 to now) Online sales _____ (rise) steadily since 2012.
3. (Task 1, a forecast for 2050) Energy demand _____ (expect / reach) 40 percent more by 2050.
4. (Task 1, a process) Next, the glass _____ (heat) to 1,500°C.
5. (Task 2, a hypothetical) If every school _____ (have) a garden, children _____ (eat) more vegetables.

My score: _____ / 5

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: ERROR HUNT AND ERROR DENSITY

Mark each sentence ✓ (no errors) or ✗ (one or more errors). Count the error-free sentences. Then correct the paragraph. There are **nine** errors.

(1) Nowadays, many students study from home for part of the week. (2) The number of online courses have grown quickly in recent years. (3) This give students more flexibility, especially those who work. (4) However, studying alone can effect motivation. (5) Some learners say they need more advices and feedback from teachers. (6) Universities should provide clear informations and regular online meetings, students can then ask questions. (7) In addition, there is an increase of demand for quiet study spaces at libraries. (8) If this trend will continue, university should plan for mixed teaching.

Error-free sentences: _____ out of 8 Is that "most"? _____

◆ WITH A PARTNER – EXERCISE 5: THE GRAMMAR UPGRADE

This paragraph is correct but flat. Rewrite it with **at least four different complex structures** and **no new errors**. Keep the same facts.

Our neighborhood library opened a study room last year. The room is quiet. Many students use it. Students get free internet there. More people now visit the library. The library wants to open the room on Sundays too.

☐ 4+ different complex structures · ☐ no new errors · ☐ same facts · ☐ no sentence longer than about 30 words

Structures I used: _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: RANGE OR ACCURACY FIRST?

Leo: I counted my sentences like the teacher said. Nine sentences, and only three are error-free.

Sara: Which errors come up most?

Leo: Articles, mostly. And I wrote "Although the rent is high, but..." twice.

Sara: Then I'd work on accuracy before range. Your sentences are already long and varied.

Leo: So no more complex sentences?

Sara: Not at all. Keep the ones you can control, and check each one for your three errors. If most of your sentences were error-free, your grammar band would probably go up.

Leo: What about you?

Sara: The opposite. Almost no errors, but every sentence starts with "There are many...". I need range.

Find a second conditional and a relative clause in the dialogue. What does each person need to work on?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PART 3 FRAMES

Answer your partner's Part 3 question for about 45 seconds. Use the two frames on your card. Your observer ticks the structures and notes any error that made the meaning unclear.

I'd say the main reason is that...

Although..., ...

..., which means that...

If..., ... would...

What is clear is that...

...far more... than...

◆ WRITE – MY ERROR LOG

Use your marked diagnostic writing. Write your three most frequent errors from the band-limiting seven.

Error type	My example	The fix, in my words	A correct sentence
1			
2			

Two complex structures I will practice until they are automatic: _____

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence is fully correct?

A) The number of tourists is increasing, causing an increase in demand for information.

B) The number of tourists are increasing every year.

C) The number of tourists is increasing, causing an increase of informations.

2

You want to add range to "Prices rose. People bought less." Which upgrade is both ranged and accurate?

A) Prices rose, people bought less.

B) Because of prices was rising, so people were buying less of things.

C) As prices rose, people bought less.

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) Although the course was short, but it was useful.

B) Although the course was short, it was useful.

C) The course was short, it was useful.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain why the grammar criterion needs both range and accuracy
- ◆ ☐ combine simple ideas with although, who / which, if and having
- ◆ ☐ choose the right tense for a chart, a process or an opinion
- ◆ ☐ find and fix the band-limiting seven errors
- ◆ ☐ count the error-free sentences in my writing and decide what to work on next

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which is your priority now: more range or more accuracy? How do you know?

Listening & Reading

Three lessons and a practice test on the two papers where good habits win marks quickly. Learn to hear an answer coming in Listening, to find answers fast in Reading without reading every word, and to prove every True / False / Not Given answer with evidence. Then try it all under exam conditions in Practice Test 1.

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C5–C8

Target band 6.0–7.5

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Listen**, **Read**, **Write**, **Say** or **With a partner**. Some exercises are **timed**: your teacher will tell you the time limit, and you work alone and in silence, as in the real test. After every timed exercise you mark your answers strictly and fill in the **error tally**. Marking strictly may feel hard, but it shows you exactly where your marks are going, and that is the fastest way to win them back.

In the partner tasks, you use an invented identity card, so you never need to share your own personal details. In discussions you can always say "Pass."

MY ERROR CODES (USE THEM AFTER EVERY TIMED EXERCISE)

Listening • **D** I wrote the distractor, not the correction • **S** spelling or plural mistake • **W** over the word limit or wrong word form • **N** I misheard a number, letter or date • **L** I lost my place or froze • **P** I missed the paraphrase • **X** transfer error (right answer, wrong box or hard to read)

Reading • **P** I missed the paraphrase • **M** I chose an answer because it used the same words as the text (word-match trap) • **S** I copied a word wrongly • **W** over the word limit or wrong word form • **O** I looked in the wrong place • **T** I ran out of time or left a blank • **F** I confused False and Not Given • **K** I used my own knowledge, not the text • **Q** I missed a qualifier (*all, some, only...*) • **H** my heading matched a detail, not the main idea • **X** transfer error (right answer, wrong box or hard to read)

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

— guess the type of answer before you hear it predict	— noun, verb, adjective, number... word class	— a phrase that says "the answer is coming" signpost	— a wrong answer the speaker mentions distractor
— the speaker changes the answer: the final version wins correction	— the same idea in different words paraphrase	— the maximum number of words you may write word limit	— minutes to copy answers to the answer sheet transfer time
— knowing where you are standing on a map orientation	— one person speaking monologue	— say a word letter by letter spell out	— stop, and miss the next answers too freeze

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — NUMBERS, LETTERS, CORRECTIONS, DIRECTIONS

The test	4 parts · 40 questions · about 30 minutes · you hear each recording once only . Part 1: a conversation about everyday life (often a form). Part 2: one speaker, everyday topic (often a map or plan). Part 3: an academic discussion (2–4 speakers). Part 4: a lecture (one speaker, no break).
-teen or -ty?	thir TEEN (long, stressed ending) · THIR ty (stress at the start) · fif TEEN / FIF ty · four TEEN / FOR ty
Phone numbers	"oh" = 0 · "double five" = 55 · numbers are said in groups: "oh-seven-seven, double-oh..."
Dates	You hear "the nineteenth of March." Write 19 March or March 19 (both are accepted).

Spelled words	"double R" = RR · careful with A / E / I, G / J, B / P / V, M / N . Capital letters are fine in the test.
Corrections (take the final version)	actually... · sorry, I mean... · no, wait... · in fact... · on second thought... · or rather... · it's not X, it's Y
Signposts (the answer is coming)	Let's move on to... · The main problem was... · What you need to remember is... · Firstly... Secondly... · The key difference is... · I'd recommend...
Directions (maps and plans)	on your left / right · opposite · next to · halfway along · beyond · at the far end · in the far corner · in the middle
The word limit	"NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER": three words = zero. If \$ or km is already printed, don't write it again.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: LETTERS AND NUMBERS

Your teacher reads ten short sentences, each one twice. Write only the answer: a name, a number, a date or a code. Be exact.

1. surname: _____ 2. price: \$ _____ 3. flight: _____
 4. surname: _____ 5. date: _____ 6. phone: _____
 7. street: _____ Road 8. population: _____ 9. distance: _____ km
 10. reference code: _____

Which ones had a trap? Circle them.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 2: A PART 1 FORM (PREDICT FIRST)

Before you listen (2 minutes): in the small column, write what **type** of answer you expect (a number? a name? a day? a plural noun?). Then listen **once** and complete the form.

Questions 1–10. Complete the form. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

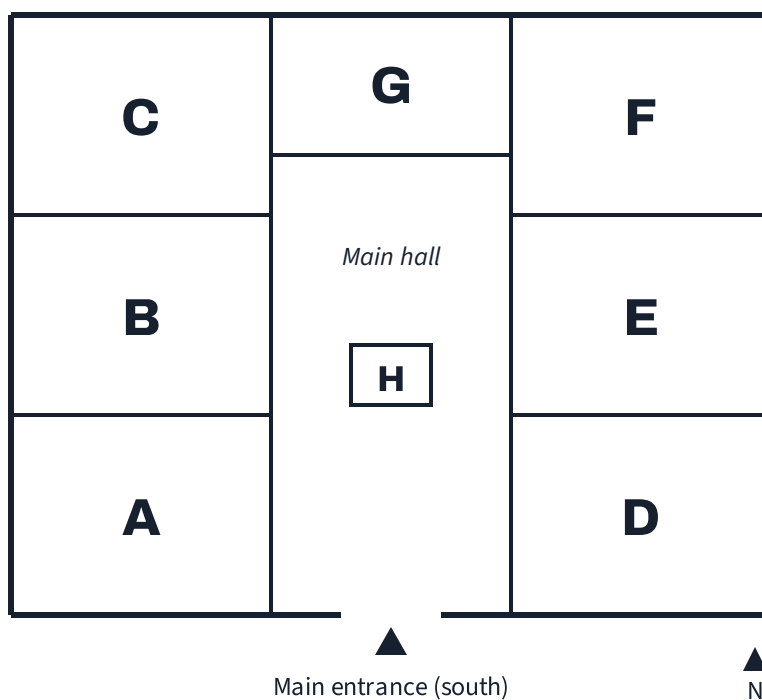
Northgate Community Center — Evening Course Enrollment		
Course	Beginners' (1) _____	type: _____
Surname	(2) _____	type: _____
First name	Daniela	
Address	(3) _____ Carlton Street	type: _____
Phone	(4) _____	type: _____

Day	(5) _____, 7–9 p.m.	type: _____
Start date	(6) _____	type: _____
Fee (city residents)	\$ (7) _____	type: _____
First evening	Room (8) _____	type: _____
Bring	a camera and spare (9) _____	type: _____
Parking	at the (10) _____ of the building	type: _____

With a partner: which answers had a **distractor**? What was the wrong answer the speaker said first?

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 3: LABEL THE PLAN

Before you listen: you are standing at the main entrance, at the bottom of the plan. Write where each letter is in words (for example, *A = inside the entrance, on the left*).



The Student Center, ground floor

Questions 11–16. Label the plan. Write the correct letter, **A–H**. (Two letters are not used.)

11. café _____ 12. computer room _____ 13. first-aid room _____

14. quiet study area _____ 15. printing center _____ 16. lost and found _____

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 4 (TIMED): PARTS 3 AND 4

Exam conditions: you hear each recording **once**. You have 30 seconds to read each set of questions first.

Questions 21–24. Choose the correct letter, **A, B or C**. *Two students, Leo and Aisha, talk to their tutor about a project.*

21. What topic have the students chosen?

A cycling safety on campus B how students travel to campus C the cost of parking

22. Why have they decided not to use an online survey?

A It would take too long to set up. B Too few people would reply. C The tutor does not allow it.

23. What does the tutor think about the number of people they plan to interview?

A It is too small. B It is about right. C It is too large.

24. What will Aisha do next?

A write the survey questions B book a room C contact the transportation office

Questions 31–35. Complete the notes. Write **ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer. *A lecture about urban heat.*

The urban heat island	
Main cause	dark surfaces, e.g. roads and especially (31) _____, absorb heat by day
Trees	cool the air by giving shade and releasing (32) _____
Waste heat	from air-conditioning units and, even more, from (33) _____
Trial solution	roofs of 40 buildings painted (34) _____
Result	top-floor temperatures fell by about (35) _____ degrees

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 5: SPOT THE CORRECTION**

Read each sentence and answer the question. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER**.

1. "The museum opens at ten — sorry, at half past ten on Sundays." When does it open on Sundays?

2. "We'll need about twenty chairs. Actually, make that twenty-five; another family is coming." How many chairs? _____

3. "The best route is via Mill Road. Well, it was, until they closed it for repairs. Take Station Road." Which road should you take? _____

4. "Registration is in the main hall, not the library as it says in the leaflet." Where is registration?

5. "The course lasts eight weeks, although the final week is optional, so most people finish in seven." How long is the course? _____

6. "I'd suggest a laptop, but honestly, a notebook and pen are all you need for the first session." What do you need for the first session? _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: A PART 1 CALL

Clerk: City Bikes, good morning. How can I help?

Caller: Hi, I'd like to rent two bikes for Saturday.

Clerk: Sure. Could I have your surname?

Caller: It's Nguyen. N-G-U-Y-E-N.

Clerk: N-G-U-Y-E-N. And a contact number?

Caller: Oh-seven-seven-double-oh, nine-double-oh, one-six-three.

Clerk: Thanks. Is that for the morning or the whole day?

Caller: Just the morning. Oh, actually, could we make it the whole day? We'd like to ride out to the lake.

Clerk: No problem. That's thirty-five dollars per bike for the day.

Caller: Thirty-five each. And what time do you open?

Clerk: Eight thirty on weekdays, but on Saturdays we open at nine.

Caller: Nine o'clock, then. See you on Saturday!

Underline the **correction** and the **distractor**. Imagine this call is a test. Write two form questions it could answer, and their answers.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – BUILD THE TRAP (INFORMATION GAP)

Caller: use an identity card from your teacher (it's invented, not you). Spell the name, say the phone number in groups, and include the **correction** printed on your card. **Receptionist:** take the call, complete the form below, then read it back. Swap roles with a new card.

Business		Surname	
Phone		Date	
Number (house / people / tickets)		Choice	

Useful language: *Could you spell that, please?* · *Was that thirteen or thirty?* · *Sorry, did you say the 14th or the 15th?* · *Let me read that back to you.*

◆ MARK AND TALLY – MY ERROR CODES TODAY

Mark Exercises 2–4 strictly (spelling and plurals count; over the limit = wrong). Write a code beside every wrong answer, then count.

D	S	W	N	L	P	Score
						____ / 25

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You hear: "The trip's on June fourth — oh, sorry, that clashes with the exam, so it's been moved to the eleventh." The question asks the date of the trip. What do you write?

A) June 11

B) June 4

C) the exam date

2

The instruction says "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER." You hear "student identification cards." What should you write?

A) student identification cards

B) identification cards

C) card

3

You hear: "The talk is in the Garrick Building — that's G-A-double R-I-C-K." The form says "_____ Building" (ONE WORD ONLY). What do you write?

A) Garick

B) GARRICK

C) Garrick Building

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ describe the four parts of IELTS Listening and explain why "once only" matters
- ◆ ☐ predict the type of answer for a gap before I listen

- ◆ ☐ hear a correction and write the final version, not the distractor
- ◆ ☐ write numbers, dates, spelled names and plurals exactly, within the word limit
- ◆ ☐ follow directions to label a map or plan
- ◆ ☐ let a missed answer go and catch the next one

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which Listening question type is hardest for you right now? Which one habit from today will you practice this week to fix it?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

— read fast for skim the general idea and structure	— move your scan eyes fast to find one thing	gist — the main idea	— a word in the question keyword that is hard to change (a name, a number)
locate — find where something is	— the topic sentence that gives a paragraph's main idea	— answers passage come in the order same order as the text	word- match — a wrong trap option that repeats the text's words
over- reading — reading every word carefully and running out of time	— a plan for time how many budget minutes to spend on each part	— cross eliminate out options that are wrong	— comparable similar enough to compare

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — THE CLOCK, AND HOW QUESTIONS PARAPHRASE THE TEXT

The test	3 passages (they get harder) · 40 questions · 60 minutes · no transfer time : write each answer on the answer sheet as soon as you find it. There is no penalty for a wrong answer, so never leave a blank.
Skim → scan → locate → answer	Skim (2–3 min): title, first and last sentence of each paragraph, signposts. Then, for each question: find the keyword, scan for it or its paraphrase, read closely only there, write the answer.
Synonym	permission → consent · similar → comparable · consider → weigh
Different word class	more visible → easier to see · to maintain → a maintenance problem
Active ↔ passive	designers delayed the paths → paving was delayed

General ↔ specific	new technology → drones, phone data
In passage order	sentence / summary completion · multiple choice · short answer · True / False / Not Given
Any order (do these last)	matching information ("Which paragraph...?") · matching features · often matching headings
Academic signposts	however (contrast) · as a result (effect) · for instance (example) · in other words (restatement) · increasingly (change) · perhaps (the writer's view)

◆ READ – THE PASSAGE

This passage was written for this course. The people, places and figures in it are invented.

PATHS OF DESIRE: WHAT SHORTCUTS REVEAL ABOUT CITIES

A Walk across almost any park, campus or housing development and you will find them: narrow strips of worn earth cutting across the grass, often ending exactly where a paved path turns a corner. Planners call these informal routes "desire paths" or "desire lines," because they record where people actually want to go rather than where designers expected them to walk. For decades, they were treated as a maintenance problem, to be fenced off or re-seeded. Increasingly, however, researchers see them as a free and remarkably honest source of data.

B The reasons people create such paths are less mysterious than they first appear. The most obvious is distance: a pedestrian facing a right-angled path will usually cut the corner if doing so saves more than a few steps. Yet distance is not the whole story. A study of three university campuses led by the urban geographer Hana Kowalski found that paths also formed where the official route passed through poorly lit areas or alongside busy parking lots, suggesting that walkers weigh comfort and perceived safety alongside time. In a small number of cases, paths appeared even though they were longer than the paved alternative.

C Once a path begins, it tends to reinforce itself. Grass that has been walked on a few times becomes thinner and easier to see, and a visible line invites the next walker to follow it. Kowalski's team estimated that on dry ground as few as fifteen crossings a week could stop a path from recovering, while on wet clay soil the figure was lower still. Walkers rarely notice that they are doing this; asked afterwards, most say they simply followed the obvious route. This feedback effect means that an entire route can be established within a single semester, long before any complaint reaches a maintenance office.

D Some institutions have turned this process to their advantage. When a new medical campus opened in the city of Aldport in 2011, its designers deliberately delayed laying most footpaths. For the first year, the grounds were simply planted with grass, and aerial photographs were taken each month. Only after the main desire lines had become clear were they paved, and a follow-up survey found that far fewer shortcuts appeared than on comparable sites. The approach was not free, however: temporary lighting and signs had to be installed, and some staff complained about muddy shoes during the wet winter months.

E Digital technology has since made the method cheaper. Anonymous location data from phones, collected with users' consent, can reveal walking patterns across a whole district in weeks rather than a year, and drones can photograph worn grass far more cheaply than aircraft. In one district, a single month of phone data identified more than forty informal routes that no survey had recorded. Critics warn, however, that such data may over-represent younger people, who are more likely to carry smartphones and share their location, and may therefore miss the routes used by older residents or by people with limited mobility, for whom a shortcut across uneven ground may be no shortcut at all.

F Perhaps the most important lesson of desire paths is not technical but philosophical. They suggest that people are not obstacles to good design but participants in it. A planner who treats every worn strip of grass as disobedience will spend years putting up fences; one who treats it as feedback may discover,

at little cost, how a place is really used. As one landscape architect put it, "The public has already drawn the plan. Our job is to read it."

◆ READ – EXERCISE 1 (TIMED, 2 MINUTES): SKIM

Skim the passage in **2 minutes**: the title, the first and last sentence of each paragraph, and any signposts. Then turn the passage over and answer.

- a) What is the whole passage about? (one line) _____
- b) Which paragraph describes a planned experiment by one organization? _____
- c) Which paragraph is about new technology? _____ d) Which paragraph gives the writer's overall conclusion? _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: SCAN RACE

Your teacher reads six questions. Scan for the answer and write the paragraph letter too. What did your eyes look for: a number, a capital letter, quotation marks?

1. _____ para _____ 2. _____ para _____
3. _____ para _____ 4. _____ para _____
5. _____ para _____ 6. _____ para _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 3: QUESTIONS 1–13

Questions 1–7 we do together, one question type at a time. Questions 8–13 are **timed** (7 minutes, alone).

Questions 1–4. Complete the sentences. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

1. In the past, desire paths were mainly regarded as a _____.
2. Kowalski's study suggests that walkers consider comfort and _____ as well as time.
3. Paths recover less easily on wet _____ soil.
4. At Aldport, monthly _____ helped the designers identify the main routes.

Questions 5–7. Choose the correct letter, **A, B or C**.

5. According to paragraph B, desire paths
A always follow the shortest route. B sometimes form along routes that are longer. C appear mainly on university campuses.
6. What does the writer say about the Aldport approach?
A It was cheaper than conventional planning. B It led to fewer shortcuts than on similar sites. C It was popular with all the staff.

7. The critics in paragraph E are concerned that digital data

A is collected without permission. B is more expensive than aerial photography. C may not reflect how all groups of people walk.

Questions 8–10 (timed). Answer the questions. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

8. What other name do planners use for desire paths? _____

9. Within what period can a complete route become established? _____

10. Apart from phone data, what has made the method cheaper? _____

Questions 11–13 (timed). Which paragraph, **A–F**, contains the following information? You may use any letter more than once.

11. a warning that a method may leave out some groups of people _____

12. an explanation of why a path becomes more noticeable over time _____

13. a contrast between where people want to walk and where designers expected them to walk

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 4: PARAPHRASE MAP**

Prove you didn't guess. For each question, write the words in the question and the words in the passage that mean the same.

Q	Question words	Passage words
1	in the past · regarded as	_____
2	consider · as well as	_____
6	similar sites	_____
7	without permission	_____
11	leave out some groups of people	_____
12	more noticeable	_____

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 5: MY TIME BUDGET**

What would you do? Write one sentence for each.

a) You've spent 26 minutes on Passage 1 and three questions are left. _____

b) You've finished Passage 1 in 15 minutes. _____

c) There are 2 minutes left, and 6 answers on Passage 3 are blank. _____

My 60-minute plan. Write the clock times for your next practice test.

Start	Move to Passage 2 by	Move to Passage 3 by	Last 2 minutes: fill every blank

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: HOW DID YOU FIND IT?

Mina: How did you get question 7? I nearly put A.

Jonas: Me too. But A says "without permission," and paragraph E says the data is collected "with users' consent."

Mina: Oh, consent means permission. So A is the opposite of the text.

Jonas: Exactly. And B says the data is more expensive, but the paragraph starts by saying technology made the method cheaper.

Mina: So it's C. But where does it say "all groups of people"?

Jonas: It doesn't, not in those words. Look at the end of E: "may miss the routes used by older residents."

Mina: I see. I was scanning for the words "all groups," so I never found it.

Jonas: They're never there. You have to scan for the idea.

Underline the two **paraphrase pairs** Jonas finds. Which option was a trap because it was the **opposite** of the text?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – EXPLAIN YOUR ROUTE

Your teacher gives you three new questions on the passage. Find your answers silently (3 minutes). Then guide your partner to each answer **without saying it**. Your partner finds it and says it.

Useful language: *Go to paragraph ____ · Look near the beginning / in the middle / at the end. · Find the word that means "____". · The question says "____"; the text says "____". · The answer is the noun / number / name after that.*

◆ MARK AND TALLY – MY ERROR CODES TODAY

Mark Questions 1–13 strictly. Write a code beside every wrong answer, then count.

P	M	S	W	O	T	Score
						____ / 13

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You've just opened a new passage. What should you do first?

- A) Read every sentence carefully from the top.
- B) Start with the matching-information questions.
- C) Skim the whole passage quickly for gist and structure.

2

The instruction says "NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS." The passage says "aging equipment," and you write "the aging equipment." What happens?

- A) Full marks: the meaning is correct.
- B) Half a mark.
- C) Zero: three words break the limit.

3

You've spent 26 minutes on Passage 1 and three questions are left. What is the best move?

- A) Keep working until you are sure of all three.
- B) Guess the three, mark them, and move to Passage 2 now.
- C) Skip Passage 2 and go straight to Passage 3.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain the Reading test format and plan about 20 minutes for each passage
- ◆ ☐ skim a passage in 2–3 minutes and say what each paragraph does
- ◆ ☐ scan for a keyword and find its paraphrase
- ◆ ☐ use the right strategy for completion, multiple choice, short answer and matching information
- ◆ ☐ obey word limits, copy spelling exactly, and never leave a blank

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which is weaker for you, skimming or scanning, and why? What is one habit you will practice this week to fix it?

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY WORDS

statement — a sentence you must judge against the text	confirm — show that something is true	contradict — say the opposite; clash with	silent (on) — gives no information about
evidence — the words in the text that prove your answer	justify — give a reason for your answer	qualifier — a small word that limits a claim (<i>some, often, may</i>)	over-claim — say more than the evidence shows
main idea — what the whole paragraph is about	detail trap — a heading that fits one sentence, not the paragraph	feature — a person, place or thing you match statements to	infer — decide something that the text doesn't state

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — THE RULE, QUALIFIERS AND EVIDENCE

TRUE (YES)	The text confirms the statement. Evidence: the paraphrase pair ("main prey" = "main food source").
FALSE (NO)	The text contradicts the statement: both can't be true. Evidence: the clashing words ("longer" vs "shorter").
NOT GIVEN	The text is silent . Evidence: "The text talks about X, but not about Y."
The deciding question	Can I point to the words that clash? Yes → False. No → Not Given.
Yes / No / Not Given	The same logic, for the writer's views (<i>argues, believes, suggests</i>). Write the words the instructions ask for: "True" on a Yes / No question scores zero.

Strong (easy to over-claim)	all · every · none · always · never · only · the most · proves · completely
Limited (careful texts)	some · a few · many · often · usually · tends to · may · might · suggests
Contradiction signals	however · but · whereas · unlike · in contrast · rather than · no longer · by contrast
Matching headings	Find each paragraph's main idea (often the first or last sentence) · do the easy ones first · cross off used headings · there are always extra headings.
Matching features	Underline every mention of each name first · match on meaning · a letter can be used more than once · do these last.

◆ READ — PASSAGE A

Written for this course; the study and people are invented. The sentence numbers are here to help you practice. The real test does not have them.

THE LATE LEARNER ADVANTAGE?

¹ For many years, it was widely assumed that adults were simply worse at learning languages than children. ² Recent research paints a more complicated picture. ³ Children who move to a new country usually develop a more native-like accent than their parents, particularly if they arrive before the age of about ten. ⁴ In the first months of study, however, adults and teenagers often make faster progress than young children, especially in grammar and vocabulary, probably because they can use strategies such as note-taking and comparing the new language with one they already know.

⁵ A study of evening-class students in the port city of Marvel, led by the linguist Tomás Reyes, followed 400 adult learners for three years. ⁶ Learners who practiced speaking with others at least twice a week were almost twice as likely to reach an intermediate level as those who studied alone. ⁷ Age, by contrast, made surprisingly little difference to progress among learners between thirty and sixty.

⁸ Reyes is careful not to overstate his results. ⁹ He points out that learners who chose to join conversation groups may already have been more confident or more motivated, so the groups themselves may not explain all of the difference. ¹⁰ Nor did the study include learners over sixty. ¹¹ What the research does suggest is that the belief that adults "can't" learn a language is not supported by the evidence, and that this belief may discourage people who would otherwise succeed.

◆ READ — EXERCISE 1: TRUE, FALSE OR NOT GIVEN? PROVE IT.

Do the statements agree with the information in Passage A? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** or **NOT GIVEN**. Then write your evidence: the sentence number and the words that prove it. For NOT GIVEN, write "The text talks about ____, but not ____."

#	Statement	Label	Sentence + evidence
1	Children who arrive in a new country before about age ten usually develop a more native-like accent than their parents.	_____	_____
2	Young children make faster progress than adults in the first months of study.	_____	_____
3	Note-taking is the most effective strategy for adult learners.	_____	_____
4	The Maravel study followed its learners for more than three years.	_____	_____
5	Most of the learners in the Maravel study were women.	_____	_____
6	Learners who practiced speaking regularly with other people were more likely to reach an intermediate level.	_____	_____
7	Among learners aged thirty to sixty, the older ones made much slower progress.	_____	_____
8	Reyes accepts that the learners in conversation groups may have been more motivated from the start.	_____	_____
9	Reyes plans to repeat the study with learners over sixty.	_____	_____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: WHAT WENT WRONG?

Three candidates explain their answers about Passage A. Each answer is wrong. Write the error code (F, K or Q) and the correct label.

- "Statement 5 is False. Most language learners in evening classes are women; I've seen it myself." Code _____ · correct label _____
- "Statement 7 is Not Given. The text doesn't say exactly how fast the older learners were." Code _____ · correct label _____
- "Statement 3 is True, because sentence 4 mentions note-taking." Code _____ · correct label _____

◆ READ – PASSAGE B

Written for this course; the people, the city and the figures are invented.

LIGHTING THE NIGHT DIFFERENTLY

A For more than a century, street lighting followed a simple rule: brighter was better. Lamps were judged by how much light they produced, and a well-lit street was assumed to be a safe one. In the last twenty years, however, that assumption has been questioned from several directions at once, and cities around the world are now rethinking how, where and when they light the night.

B The first push came from technology. Light-emitting diodes, or LEDs, use far less electricity than the older sodium lamps they replace, and they last several times longer. For city budgets, the argument was hard to resist. The engineer Marcus Hale, who advised on the replacement of 30,000 streetlights in the city of Brenton, estimates that the switch cut the city's lighting bill by more than half within five years, although the initial purchase cost was considerable.

C Yet the new lamps brought an unexpected problem. Early LEDs produced a cold, bluish-white light, and many residents found it harsh; complaints about light shining into bedrooms were common. The sleep researcher Dr. Priya Nair argues that blue-rich light at night can delay the body's release of melatonin, a hormone that helps regulate sleep, and she recommends warmer-colored lamps for residential streets. She stresses, however, that the effect of streetlights is small compared with that of phones and computer screens used in bed.

D Wildlife researchers have raised similar concerns. Many insects are drawn to artificial light, and some studies have linked brighter streets with fewer moths and other night-flying insects in the surrounding area. Bats that hunt in darkness may avoid lit routes altogether. For ecologists, the question is not only how bright a lamp is, but also which way its light travels: a lamp that sends light sideways and upward affects a far wider area than one that points straight down.

E Perhaps the most surprising finding concerns safety itself. When Brenton dimmed its lights by forty percent after midnight on quieter streets, some residents feared a rise in crime. According to the city council, reported crime on those streets did not rise over the following two years. Hale is cautious about the result: he notes that crime was already falling across the country during the same period, and that busy streets and the town center were never dimmed.

F What is emerging is a more flexible approach. Instead of treating light as a fixed utility, some cities now use "smart" lamps that brighten when a pedestrian or cyclist approaches and dim again when the street is empty. Brenton council plans to install such systems on all residential streets by 2030. Nair welcomes the idea but argues that residents should be consulted street by street, since the needs of a hospital entrance and a quiet dead-end street are very different.

◆ READ – EXERCISE 3 (TIMED, 8 MINUTES): MATCHING HEADINGS

Passage B has six paragraphs, **A–F**. Choose the correct heading for paragraphs **B–F** from the list. There are more headings than paragraphs.

i	A shift in thinking about an old assumption	v	The effect of lighting on nighttime wildlife
ii	Why new lamps made financial sense	vi	Testing the link between light and safety

iii	How screens affect our sleep	vii	A rise in crime after midnight
iv	Concerns about the color of light and human health	viii	Lighting that responds to the people using it

Example: Paragraph A → i

1. Paragraph B _____ 2. Paragraph C _____ 3. Paragraph D _____ 4. Paragraph E _____
5. Paragraph F _____

For each paragraph, write its main idea in five words or fewer before you choose.

◆ READ – EXERCISE 4 (TIMED, 5 MINUTES): MATCHING FEATURES

Match each statement with the correct person or organization, **A–C**. You may use any letter more than once.

A Marcus Hale · **B** Dr. Priya Nair · **C** Brenton city council

6. recommends warmer-colored lamps for streets where people live _____
7. reported that crime did not increase on the dimmed streets _____
8. points out that a national trend may partly explain a result _____
9. believes residents should be asked about changes to their street _____
10. estimated how much money the new lamps saved _____
11. intends to install responsive lighting on every residential street _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: QUALIFIERS

Circle the qualifier in the statement. Then write **T**, **F** or **NG**.

1. Text: "Some cities now use smart lamps." Statement: "Every city now uses smart lamps." _____
2. Text: "LEDs last several times longer than sodium lamps." Statement: "LEDs usually last longer than sodium lamps." _____
3. Text: "Bats may avoid lit routes." Statement: "Bats never hunt near streetlights." _____
4. Text: "Reported crime on those streets did not rise." Statement: "Crime fell sharply on the dimmed streets." _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: FALSE OR NOT GIVEN?

Ana: For statement 5, I put False. "Most of the learners were women."

Karim: OK, prove it. Can you point to the words that clash?

Ana: Well... sentence 5 says "400 adult learners." It doesn't say anything about women.

Karim: Right. And it doesn't say anything about men, either. It just doesn't tell us.

Ana: So it's Not Given, not False.

Karim: Exactly. False needs a clash, like statement 4. The text says "three years," whereas the statement says "more than three years."

Ana: Got it. So my evidence for 5 is: "The text talks about the number of learners, but not about whether they were men or women."

Karim: Perfect. That's what "prove it" means.

Underline the **evidence language** the speakers use. Which sentence tells you how to decide between False and Not Given?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PROVE IT DEBATES

Take a debate card. It gives a statement and tells each of you which answer to argue. Find your evidence (30 seconds), argue for 30 seconds each, then agree on the real answer together. "I think" and "I know" don't count: point to the text.

Useful language: *The text says X, whereas the statement says Y. · There's no mention of... · Sentence ___ confirms it: "... is a paraphrase of "... · The word "only" / "all" makes it false. · Right, it doesn't. (not "Yes, it doesn't")*

Our agreed answer and one line of evidence:

◆ MARK AND TALLY – MY ERROR CODES TODAY

Mark Exercises 1, 3 and 4. Write a code beside every wrong answer, then count.

F	K	Q	H	P	O	Score
						___ / 20

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A passage says "The museum opened in 1980." The statement reads: "The museum was the first of its kind in the country." The answer is:

A) Not Given

B) False

C) True

2

A paragraph is mainly about how solar panels are manufactured, but one line says they are expensive. Which heading is the trap?

A) "How solar panels are made"

B) "The high cost of solar panels"

C) "The production process of solar technology"

3

Text: "Only a few species of frog can survive being frozen." Statement: "Most frogs can survive freezing." The answer is:

A) True

B) False

C) Not Given

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain the difference between True, False and Not Given, and between T/F/NG and Yes/No/NG
- ◆ ☐ tell False from Not Given by pointing to the words that clash
- ◆ ☐ prove every answer with evidence from the text
- ◆ ☐ notice qualifiers and ignore my own knowledge of the topic
- ◆ ☐ match a heading to the main idea of a paragraph, not a detail
- ◆ ☐ match statements to people or organizations, and do these questions last

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write the rule for False versus Not Given in your own words. Then write the one check you will do on every tricky statement from now on.

WHAT THIS TEST IS FOR

Practice Test 1 is a **map**, not a verdict. It shows where your marks are going, so you can spend the next weeks on the things that will make the biggest difference. Your score is private: nobody else will see it unless you choose to show them. Many learners gain about half a band over a course like this; some gain more, some less, and the practice you do at home matters most. In Class C15 you will take Practice Test 2 and compare.

◆ BEFORE THE TEST (COMPLETE IN CLASS C7)

- ◆ ☐ I know the time and I will arrive 10 minutes early.
- ◆ ☐ I will bring two pencils, an eraser and water in a clear bottle.
- ◆ ☐ My phone will be off and in my bag.
- ◆ ☐ In Listening, I will use the reading time to predict, take the correction, and let a missed answer go.
- ◆ ☐ In Reading, I will write answers on the answer sheet as I go, move on at my checkpoint times, and fill every blank.
- ◆ ☐ If I feel nervous, I will put my pencil down, breathe out slowly, and carry on.

My Reading checkpoints: Passage 2 by minute _____ · Passage 3 by minute _____

◆ MY RESULTS (COMPLETE IN CLASS C9)

	Raw score	Estimated band (from the conversion table)
Listening	____ / 40	
Reading	____ / 40	

The estimated band is a range, about half a band either way. This is a practice test read aloud by your teacher, not an official result.

◆ MY ERROR TALLY

Code	Meaning	Listening	Reading
D	wrote the distractor		—
S	spelling or plural / copied wrongly		
W	over the word limit / wrong form		

N	misheard a number, letter or date		—
L	lost my place or froze		—
P	missed the paraphrase		
M	word-match trap	—	
O	looked in the wrong place	—	
T	ran out of time / left a blank	—	
F	confused False and Not Given	—	
K	used my own knowledge	—	
Q	missed a qualifier	—	
H	heading matched a detail	—	
X	transfer error (wrong box / hard to read)		

◆ MY TWO LEAKS AND MY PLAN

My two biggest codes: _____ and _____

What I will practice each week until Practice Test 2 (how, how often, where):

Academic Writing

Three lessons, three jobs. Task 1: **report** a chart clearly and objectively, with an overview the examiner can find in three seconds. Task 2: **argue** by answering exactly the question that was asked, with two ideas developed properly. Then **judge**: read writing the way an examiner does, criterion by criterion, starting with other people's scripts and ending with your own.

Lessons **3.1–3.3**Classes **C9–C11**Target band **6.0–7.5**

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Write, Listen, Say, Read, With a partner** or **Timed**. Timed tasks are practice under exam conditions: it is normal to feel rushed, and it is normal not to finish the first time. What you learn from the self-marking afterward matters more than the result.

When a task asks for your own ideas or examples, you decide what to share. Use your real life, **or** a new identity card, **or** an example you invent. In IELTS, an example must be relevant and specific; it does not have to be true.

◆ PRACTICE TEST 1 – MY RESULTS

A test result is a map, not a verdict. Write your scores, then put one stroke (|) in the grid for every mark you lost.

	Raw score (/40)	Approximate band	C1 diagnostic band
Listening			
Reading			

Listening: error type	Tally	Reading: error type	Tally
D distractor (wrote the first / corrected-away answer)		P missed the paraphrase	
S spelling or plural		M word-match trap (same words, different meaning)	
W word limit / wrong form		S copied a word wrongly	
N number, letter or date misheard		W word limit / wrong form	
L lost my place / froze		O looked in the wrong place	
P missed the paraphrase		T ran out of time / left a blank	
X transfer error (right answer, wrong box / illegible)		F confused False and Not Given	
		K used own knowledge, not the text	
		Q missed a qualifier (<i>all, some, only...</i>)	
		H heading matched a detail, not the main idea	
		X transfer error	
Other		Other	

My biggest error type: _____

One thing I will do about it before Practice Test 2: _____

◆ READ AND SAY – NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

— the big picture: the one or two main features, no figures an overview	— a highest or lowest value, a big change, a crossover, a stable figure a key feature	— to put related data together instead of describing it item by item to group	— to say the same thing in different words to paraphrase
— the general direction of change over time a trend	— a part of a whole (a third, 12%) a proportion / a share	— to go from below something to above it to overtake	— to stop rising or falling and stay the same to level off / to plateau
— to go up and down with no clear direction to fluctuate	— to reach the highest point to peak at	— in the same order as the items just mentioned respectively	— not exactly, but close approximately / roughly

rose sharply	a sharp rise in	fell slightly	a gradual decline in	remained stable
peaked at	doubled	a fivefold increase	accounted for	the largest share
well over a quarter				just under half

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

The shape of a Task 1 report (at least 150 words, about 20 minutes, no opinions, no reasons that the chart doesn't show)

1 Introduction	Paraphrase the task: what, where, when. <i>The line graph compares the proportion of...</i>
2 Overview	"Overall, ..." The one or two biggest features. No figures.
3 Body A	Figures for the first group of data, with comparisons.
4 Body B	Figures for the second group. (No conclusion: the overview does that job.)

Two ways to describe a change

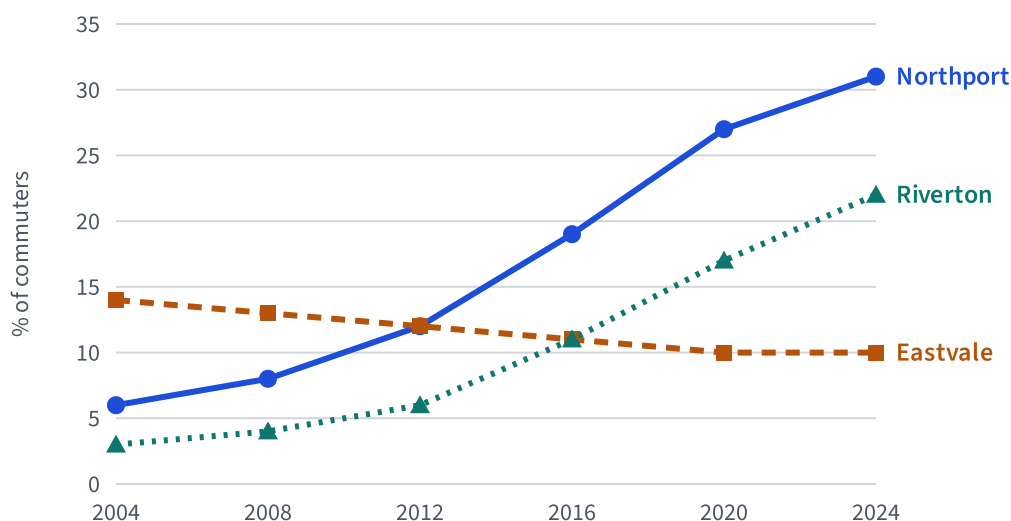
Verb + adverb	Cycling rose sharply . · Coal use fell slightly . · The figure remained stable .
----------------------	---

There was + adjective + noun + in	There was a sharp rise in cycling. · There was a slight fall in coal use.
Irregular verbs	rise – rose – risen · fall – fell – fallen · grow – grew – grown (not <i>rised</i>)
Prepositions	rose from 6% to 31% · by 25 points · peaked at 31% · a rise of 6 hours in paid work
Proportion	accounted for · made up · the largest share of · twice as many as · the majority of
Approximation	just over a quarter (26%) · just under half (48%) · roughly a third (34%)
Process	present simple passive + <i>First, ... Next, ... After that, ... Finally, ...</i>

Sentence skeletons: The chart shows ___ in ___ between ___ and ___. · Overall, ___, while ___. · In [year], ___ stood at ___, compared with ___. · By [year], ___ had risen to ___.

◆ READ – CHART 1 AND A MODEL REPORT

The task: The line graph shows the percentage of commuters who cycled to work in three cities between 2004 and 2024. Summarize the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. (*All cities and figures are invented.*)



(A) The line graph compares the proportion of commuters who cycled to work in three cities, Northport, Eastvale and Riverton, at four-year intervals between 2004 and 2024.

(B) Overall, cycling to work became far more common in Northport and Riverton, whereas it declined slightly in Eastvale. As a result, Eastvale, which had the highest rate at the start of the period, had the lowest by the end.

(C) In 2004, 14% of commuters in Eastvale cycled, compared with just 6% in Northport and 3% in Riverton. Northport's figure then rose steadily, drawing level with Eastvale's at 12% in 2012 and overtaking it soon afterward, before climbing steeply to reach 31% in 2024, the highest rate shown.

(D) Riverton followed a similar but later pattern. After remaining very low until 2012, its rate increased sharply, drawing level with Eastvale at 11% in 2016 and ending the period at 22%. Eastvale, by contrast, saw a gradual fall to 10% in 2020, after which the figure remained stable.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: THE JOBS OF THE PARAGRAPHS

1. Which paragraph is the overview? _____ Does it contain a number? _____
2. Which paragraph paraphrases the task? _____ Write two words that were changed from the task: _____ → _____
3. How is the data grouped in paragraphs C and D? _____
4. Find two verb + adverb phrases: _____
5. Find one word that means "went from below to above": _____ and one phrase that means "reached the same level": _____
6. Is there any opinion or reason in the report? _____

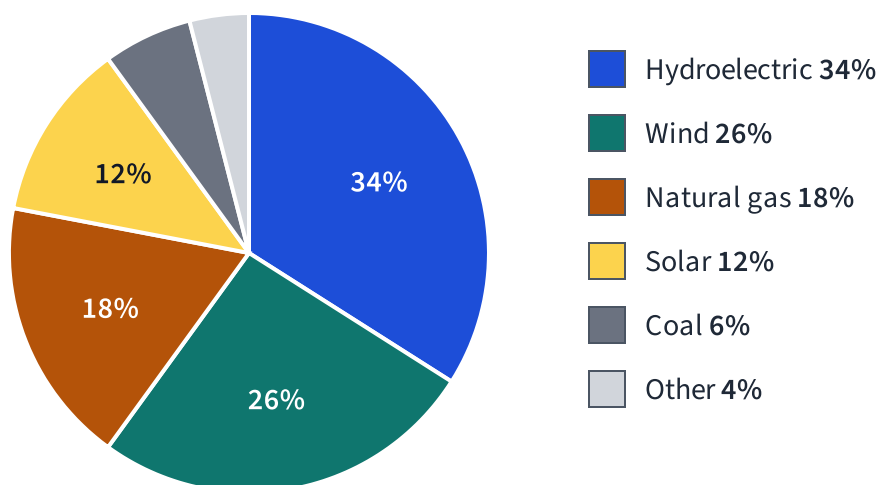
◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: CHOOSE THE ACCURATE WORDS

Circle the better option. Look at Chart 1 and the figures.

1. Between 2004 and 2008, cycling in Northport rose **slightly** / **dramatically**, from 6% to 8%.
2. Northport's figure increased **to** / **by** 25 percentage points over the whole period.
3. There was a steep **rise** / **rose** in Riverton after 2012.
4. The rate in Eastvale **remained stable** / **fluctuated** between 2020 and 2024.
5. Riverton's figure **raised** / **rose** from 6% to 22% in twelve years.
6. In 2024, Northport's rate was roughly **three times** / **twice** that of Eastvale.
7. Northport and Riverton ended the period at 31% and 22% **respectively** / **relatively**.
8. Eastvale saw a gradual decline **of** / **in** 4 points.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: THE OVERVIEW (CHART 3)

The pie chart shows the sources of electricity in the region of Lakeland in 2024. Write a two-sentence overview: the biggest features, **no figures**.



◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: SELECT AND GROUP (CHART 4, A TABLE)

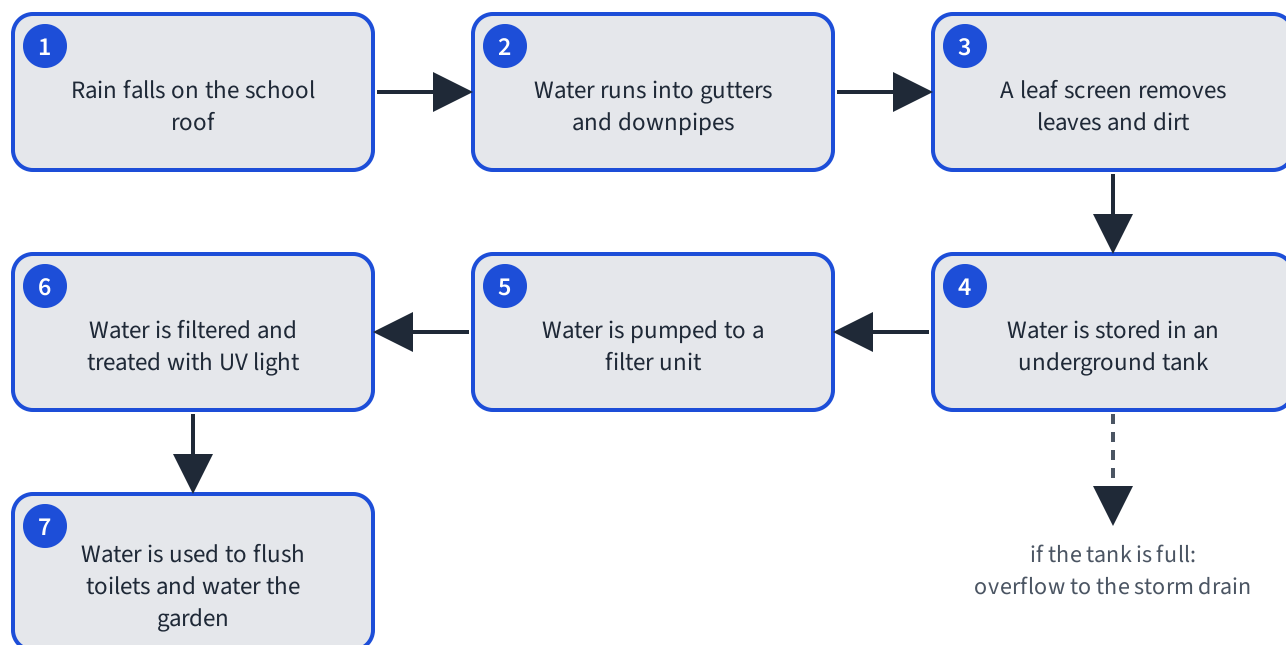
Average one-way commute in five cities, 2024 (invented data)

City	Average time (minutes)	% by car	% by public transportation	% walking or cycling
Ashby	42	61	30	9
Brenton	28	35	45	20
Calder	35	48	40	12
Dunmore	19	22	26	52
Elston	51	70	25	5

- Which city had the longest commute? _____ The shortest? _____
- In which city did most people walk or cycle? _____
- In which city was public transportation the most common way to travel? _____
- What pattern connects the time column and the car column? _____
- You will write two body paragraphs. Which cities go together in each? Body A: _____ Body B: _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: A PROCESS (CHART 5)

The diagram shows how rainwater is collected and reused in a school building. Rewrite each stage in the **passive** where possible and add a sequencer (*First, Next, After that, Then, Once..., Finally*).



1. _____ rain falls on the school roof and _____ into gutters and downpipes.
2. _____ leaves and dirt _____ by a leaf screen.
3. _____ the water _____ in an underground tank.
4. _____ it _____ to a filter unit, where it _____.
5. _____ the clean water _____ to flush toilets and water the garden.
6. Write the overview: how many stages? Linear or a cycle? _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: CHECKING THE OVERVIEW

Lina: Can you check my overview? "Overall, paid work increased from 6 to 12 hours, and lectures fell from 14 to 11."

Ravi: It's accurate, but it's full of numbers. That sounds like body paragraph detail.

Lina: So what should the overview say, if not the figures?

Ravi: The shape of the story. Which activities grew, which ones shrank, and anything surprising.

Lina: OK. "Overall, students spent more time on paid work and online lessons, and less on lectures and independent study."

Ravi: Much better. And the surprising part? Look at 2024.

Lina: Oh, paid work overtook lectures. Should I say that's because students need more money now?

Ravi: I wouldn't. The chart doesn't tell us why. Just say that paid work became the most time-consuming activity.

Lina: Fair enough. Save the opinions for Task 2.

Underline the two overviews. Why is the second one better? What does Ravi advise about reasons?

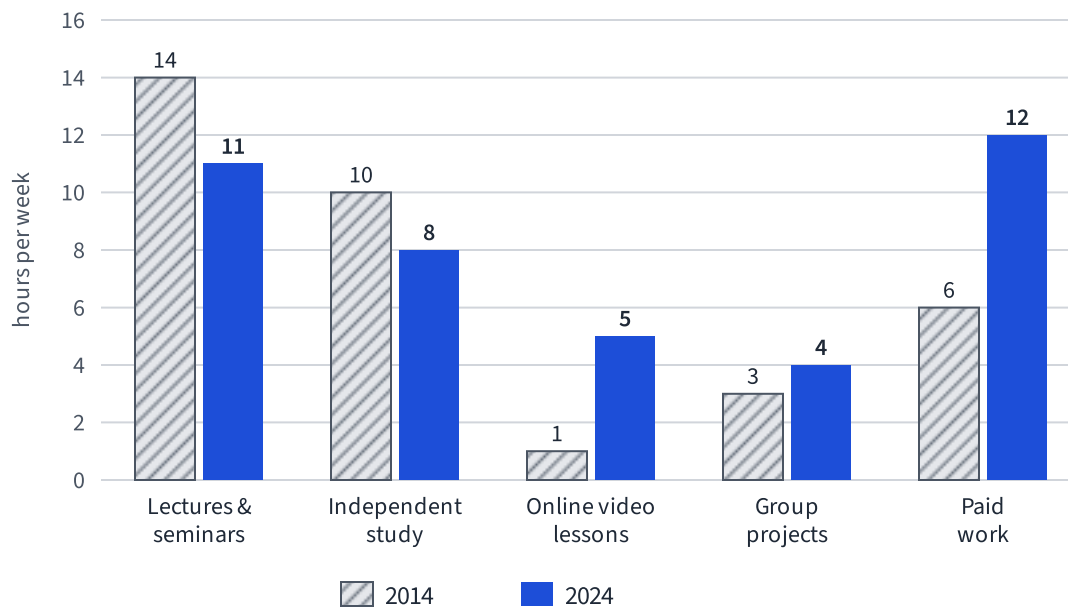
◆ WITH A PARTNER – CHART TALK

Your teacher gives you a card with data. Don't show it. In about one minute, describe it: **overview first**, then three key features with figures. Your partner sketches the chart on the grid on their card and asks one question. Then swap.

Useful: *My chart shows...* · *Overall, the main point is...* · *The highest / lowest was...* · *It rose from... to...* · *Just under a third...*

◆ TIMED – TASK 1 UNDER EXAM CONDITIONS (20 MINUTES)

The task: The bar chart shows the average number of hours per week that first-year students at one university spent on five activities in 2014 and 2024. Summarize the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words. (*Invented data.*)



2 min plan: underline the biggest changes; decide your two groups · 14 min write · 4 min count and check

Word count: _____

Task Achievement checklist (my own report)

- ◆ ☐ at least 150 words, written in about 20 minutes
- ◆ ☐ the introduction paraphrases the task (not copied)
- ◆ ☐ a clear overview that starts "Overall, ..." and has **no figures**
- ◆ ☐ key features selected and grouped, not every number listed
- ◆ ☐ at least two accurate comparisons (*overtook, twice as many, whereas*)

- ◆ ☐ no opinions and no reasons the chart doesn't show
- ◆ ☐ varied trend language; correct prepositions (*from, to, by, in*)

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which paragraph of a Task 1 report is the most important for your band, and why?

A) The introduction, because it comes first.

B) The overview: without a clear one, Task Achievement is capped around band 5.

C) The first body paragraph, because it has the most figures.

2

A value drops from 90 to 12 in a single year. Which is the most accurate description?

A) It declined gradually.

B) It fluctuated.

C) It plummeted / fell sharply.

3

Which sentence about Chart 2 is accurate and suitable for a Task 1 report?

A) Time spent on paid work rose from 6 to 12 hours, doubling over the period.

B) Paid work rised by 12 hours because students need more money.

C) I think paid work increased a lot, which is worrying.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ name my biggest error type from Practice Test 1 and one fix for it
- ◆ ☐ organize a Task 1 report in four paragraphs
- ◆ ☐ write an overview that gives the big picture without figures
- ◆ ☐ select and group key features instead of listing every number
- ◆ ☐ describe trends, proportions and processes accurately, with the right prepositions
- ◆ ☐ write 150 words in 20 minutes and check my own report

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which trend words do you overuse? Write one sentence about a change in your week (real or invented) with a verb + adverb, then rewrite it with *There was a... in....*

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

a prompt — the question you must answer	instruction words — the words <i>discuss</i> that <i>both</i> tell you what to do <i>views</i> <i>to what extent</i> (	a position / a stance — what you think, stated clearly	a thesis — the sentence in the introduction that gives your answer to the whole question
a topic sentence — the first sentence of a body paragraph; it states the paragraph's one idea	to develop — to explain why, show the consequence and give an example	a verdict — a final judgment (which side is stronger)	to outweigh — to be more important than
relevant — directly connected to the question	a concession — admitting that the other side has a point		

It is often argued that...

While..., I believe...

The most compelling reason is...

This is because...

..., which means that...

For example, ...

Admittedly, ...

In conclusion, ...

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Question type = the job. Read the instruction words and count the parts.

Opinion	To what extent do you agree or disagree?	one clear position, held from the thesis to the conclusion
----------------	--	--

Discussion	Discuss both views and give your own opinion.	view A · view B · your opinion (3 jobs)
Problem–solution	What problems...? What can be done?	body 1 problems · body 2 solutions
Advantages–disadvantages	Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?	both sides + a clear verdict
Two-part	Why is this happening? Is it positive?	answer each question directly

Build a paragraph: one idea, developed.

Topic sentence	The most serious problem is the effect on physical health.
Why?	This is because the body burns very little energy when we sit.
So what?	Over time, this can lead to back pain, which means more sick days.
Example	A call-center worker who sits for eight hours, for example, may rarely walk more than a few hundred steps.

Register: no contractions, no slang, no "you" talking to the reader, no memorized openers ("In this modern era..."). Use *can*, *may*, *tends to*, *many* to avoid overclaiming.

◆ **WRITE – EXERCISE 1: WHAT'S THE JOB?**

Write the question type and the number of parts. (*All prompts are original practice prompts.*)

P1 Some people believe that all high school students should learn to cook as part of their regular schedule. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Type: _____ Parts: _____

P2 Some people think the best way to reduce food waste is to teach households how to plan, store and cook food better. Others believe supermarkets and restaurants should be made responsible for cutting waste. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Type: _____ Parts: _____

P3 Many people now spend most of their working day sitting down. What problems does this cause, and what measures could be taken to solve them?

Type: _____ Parts: _____

P4 More and more adults are returning to education in their thirties and forties. Why is this happening? Is it a positive development?

Type: _____ Parts: _____

P5 In some companies, employees can choose their own working hours. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages?

Type: _____ Parts: _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: UPGRADE THE THESIS

Each thesis is weak. Rewrite it so it states a clear position.

1. (P1) This essay will talk about cooking lessons.

→ _____

2. (P5) There are many advantages and disadvantages of flexible hours.

→ _____

3. (P2) Food waste is a big problem in the world nowadays.

→ _____

4. (P4) I will discuss why adults return to education.

→ _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: THE FIVE-MINUTE PLAN

Complete the plan for **P2** as your teacher thinks aloud. Then plan **P1** on your own in five minutes.

	P2 (with the teacher)	P1 (on my own)
Type · parts		
My position (thesis)		
Body 1: idea → because → example		
Body 2: idea → because → example		
Conclusion (no new idea)		

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: DEVELOP A THIN POINT

This is a list, not a paragraph: *"Flexible hours are good. Parents like them. Traffic is less. Companies can benefit."* Choose **one** idea and develop it: topic sentence → why → so what → example.

◆ READ – EXERCISE 5: MODEL ESSAY A (P2, DISCUSSION)

(1) A large share of the food produced in many countries is never eaten, and there is disagreement about who should take the lead in reducing this waste. While educating households has clear value, I believe that the greater responsibility lies with supermarkets and restaurants, because their decisions shape what everyone else buys and throws away.

(2) Those who favor educating households argue that most waste happens at home. When families plan meals, store fresh produce correctly and learn to cook with leftovers, they buy less and discard less, which also saves them money. A short community cooking course, for example, can show parents how to turn vegetables that are past their best into soups or sauces, a habit that may last for years. Such skills also tend to spread, since children who grow up in these households often learn the same habits.

(3) However, individual effort can only go so far when businesses encourage over-buying. Supermarkets often sell fruit in large multipacks and run "buy one, get one free" offers, so shoppers take home more than they can use. Restaurants, meanwhile, frequently serve portions that are too large for one person. If these businesses were required to offer smaller packs, donate unsold food and measure their own waste, the effect would reach millions of customers at once, rather than depending on each family changing its habits. Where large stores have already been required to donate edible surplus food to charities, considerable amounts of waste have been prevented.

(4) In conclusion, teaching households to manage food better is worthwhile, but it treats the symptoms rather than the cause. I am convinced that making supermarkets and restaurants responsible would reduce waste more quickly and on a much larger scale.

1. Underline the thesis. What is the writer's position? _____

2. Which paragraph gives view A? _____ View B? _____ Where is the writer's opinion?

3. Copy the topic sentence of paragraph 3: _____

4. Find a "so what?" consequence in paragraph 2: _____

5. Does the conclusion add a new idea? _____ 6. Find one concession:

Ana: I've got my plan for the question about adults going back to school. I'm going to write about why it's good.

Ben: Let me see the prompt. "Why is this happening? Is it a positive development?" That's two questions.

Ana: Right, but they're connected, aren't they?

Ben: They are, but if you only answer the second one, half the task is missing. I'd give one body paragraph to the reasons and one to whether it's positive.

Ana: OK. Reasons: jobs are changing, so people need new skills. And online courses make it easier.

Ben: Good. Can you pick one and push it? Why do jobs change? So what?

Ana: Because technology replaces some tasks, which means people in their forties may need a second career. For example, a bank clerk retraining as a nurse.

Ben: That's a developed point. And your answer to the second question?

Ana: Mostly positive, as long as courses are affordable. That's my thesis.

What did Ana forget at first? What does "push it" mean? Underline Ana's thesis.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – PLAN PITCH

Draw a prompt card. Plan for **2 minutes**, then pitch your plan in **1 minute**: "This is a ____ question, so I need to _____. My position is _____. Body 1: _____ because _____; for example, _____. Body 2: ...". Your partner checks: ☐ type right ☐ all parts answered ☐ one idea per body ☐ a specific example ☐ no new idea in the conclusion, and asks you "So what?" once. Then swap.

◆ TIMED – PLAN AND OPENING (20 MINUTES)

Choose **P3** (sitting at work) or **P5** (choosing your working hours) from Exercise 1.

5 minutes: plan (type · position · two ideas · examples) · **15 minutes:** write the introduction and body paragraph 1. At home: finish the essay (250+ words, 40 minutes in total) and bring it to the next class.

Task Response checklist (so far)

- ◆ ☐ I named the question type and counted the parts
- ◆ ☐ my introduction paraphrases the prompt and ends with a clear thesis
- ◆ ☐ body 1 has one idea, with a topic sentence, a why, a so what and a specific example
- ◆ ☐ my plan covers every part of the prompt
- ◆ ☐ formal register: no contractions, no memorized opener

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A prompt says "Discuss both views and give your own opinion." Which approach best answers it?

A) Present both views fairly, and make your own opinion clear in the introduction and conclusion.

B) Argue strongly for the view you hold and ignore the other.

C) List as many arguments as possible from both sides and give no opinion.

2

What is the main job of the thesis in your introduction?

A) To give a detailed example supporting one side.

B) To state your position or answer to the question clearly.

C) To copy the exam question word for word.

3

"More adults are returning to education. Why is this happening? Is it a positive development?" Which plan fits best?

A) Body 1: advantages · Body 2: disadvantages · no opinion.

B) Three body paragraphs, all about why it is positive.

C) Body 1: the reasons · Body 2: whether it is positive, with a clear answer.

- ◆ ☐ identify a Task 2 question type and count its parts
- ◆ ☐ plan an essay in five minutes that answers every part
- ◆ ☐ write a thesis that states my position
- ◆ ☐ write topic sentences that announce one idea each
- ◆ ☐ develop a point with why, so what and a specific example

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which question type feels hardest for you, and why?
Write the one fix you'll practice this week.

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

a criterion (plural criteria)	) — one of the four the examiner judges	— ideas in a logical order; one idea per paragraph	— the links between sentences: linkers, reference, substitution	a linker / a cohesive device — a word that shows a relationship (
reference — pointing back (	it, this a measure, these noun pressures	— a noun that names a whole idea (	— done by habit, without thinking about meaning	a band- limiter — a fault that caps your band (no overview, off topic, under length)
to estimate — to make a careful guess				

◆ THE FOUR CRITERIA (PARAPHRASED FROM THE PUBLIC IELTS BAND DESCRIPTORS)

Each criterion counts 25% of the task band. This is a guide for estimating, in our own words, not the official wording. Task 1 uses **Task Achievement** (overview, key features, accurate data) instead of Task Response.

	About band 5	About band 6	About band 7	About band 8
Task Response	answers only part of the question; position unclear; ideas thin or repeated	answers all parts, some more than others; a position, but development uneven or conclusion unclear	answers all parts; a clear position throughout; main ideas extended and supported	answers all parts well; a clear position; ideas well developed with relevant, specific support
Coherence & Cohesion	some organization; linkers overused, missing or wrong;	clear overall; linking works but can be mechanical; reference not	logical order; a range of linkers used well, perhaps a little over- or	ideas in a smooth sequence; linking and reference well managed and rarely

	repetitive; weak or no paragraphing	always clear; paragraphs mostly logical	under-used; one clear idea per paragraph	noticeable; paragraphs well judged
Lexical Resource	limited words, repeated; errors in spelling or word form that may make the reader work	enough words for the task; tries less common words, sometimes inaccurately; errors don't block meaning	enough range to be flexible and precise; some less common words and collocations; occasional slips	a wide range used fluently and precisely; natural collocations; rare, minor slips
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	limited structures; complex sentences attempted but often wrong; frequent errors	a mix of simple and complex sentences; errors present but meaning usually clear	a variety of complex structures; many sentences error-free; good control, a few errors	a wide range of structures; most sentences error-free; only occasional slips

Your band is often held down by your **weakest** criterion. Fix that one first.

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Contrast	However, · whereas · while · Nevertheless, · On the other hand, (not <i>On the contrary</i>)
Cause / result	because · since · As a result, · Consequently, · which means that
Adding	In addition, · Furthermore, · also · not only... but also
Example	For example, · For instance, · such as · A clear example of this is...
Reference	this / these + summary noun · such (a) + noun · the former / the latter · doing so

Repetitive: Governments could raise fuel taxes. Raising fuel taxes would reduce car use.

Referenced: Governments could raise fuel taxes. **This measure** would reduce car use.

The over-linking trap: a linker on every sentence sounds mechanical and is marked down. Link only a real relationship (a real contrast, a real result). A new paragraph and a summary noun often do the job better.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 1: WHICH CRITERION?

Write TR, CC, LR or GRA.

1. The essay never states a clear position. _____
2. Every sentence starts with *Firstly / Moreover / In addition*. _____
3. The word *important* appears eleven times. _____
4. Every sentence is short and simple. _____

5. The essay is one long block with no paragraphs. _____ 6. Articles (*a / the*) are missing throughout. _____

7. A discussion essay gives only one view. _____ 8. "make a research," "do a mistake," "goverment." _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: FIX THE OVER-LINKED PARAGRAPH

Rewrite this paragraph with two or three well-chosen links and at least one *this / these + noun*.

Firstly, many people now shop online. Moreover, deliveries are increasing. In addition, delivery vans are filling the streets. Furthermore, a lot of packaging is thrown away. Therefore, online shopping has a cost. Consequently, companies should find solutions. In conclusion, action is needed.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: NAME IT WITH A SUMMARY NOUN

Complete the second sentence with *This / These / Such + a noun (trend, measure, approach, problem, change, view, risk)*.

1. Fewer young people are learning to drive. _____ may reduce traffic in the long term.

2. Some schools have banned phones in class. _____ has divided parents.

3. Many cities offer free bicycles for short trips. _____ encourages people to leave their cars at home.

4. Some people argue that exams should be replaced by projects. _____ is popular among teachers.

5. Rents are rising, and young adults are staying with their parents longer. _____ affect family life in many ways.

6. Libraries may cut their book budgets too far. _____ worries many regular readers.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: MAKE IT COHERENT

Put the sentences in order, add a topic sentence at the start, and join them with one linker and one reference word.

a) The savings can be used for other household costs. · b) However, the food is not always as healthy as it looks. · c) Many families now buy ready-made meals to save time. · d) These meals are often cheaper than cooking from fresh ingredients.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – EXAMINER PANEL

Your group judges three anonymous scripts (from your teacher). Each person judges **one** criterion, gives a band (5, 6, 7 or 8) and **quotes** the script as evidence. Rotate roles for each script.

Script	TR	CC	LR	GRA	Average $\approx$ band	Our best quotation
A						
B						
C						

Rounding: an average ending in .25 goes up to .5; an average ending in .75 goes up to the next whole band.
 After the reveal: where was your panel furthest from the commentary? _____

◆ WRITE – MY ESSAY: FOUR PASSES

Read your own essay four times, once per criterion. Be honest: pretend it is a stranger's.

Criterion	My band estimate	Evidence (quote)	One concrete improvement
Task Response			
Coherence & Cohesion			
Lexical Resource			
Grammatical Range & Accuracy			

The criterion holding me back: _____

Timed rewrite (8 minutes): rewrite the one paragraph that most needs the fix.

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: COMPARING ESTIMATES

Kofi: We gave Script A a 6 for Coherence. The commentary says 6 too. But we said 6 for Task Response, and it says 7.

Mei: Why did we go lower?

Kofi: I thought the third body paragraph was too short.

Mei: It is short, but the position is clear from start to finish, and the first two ideas are developed with examples.

Kofi: Fair point. So a short paragraph doesn't cancel everything else.

Mei: Exactly. And for Script B, I'd argue the Coherence is a 5, not a 6. Look at paragraph two: every single sentence starts with a linker.

Kofi: And "Moreover" introduces a contrast, which is wrong. OK, I'm convinced.

Find two phrases for disagreeing politely and one for accepting a point.

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A writer begins every sentence with "Firstly, Moreover, In addition, Consequently, In conclusion." What is the likely effect on the Coherence & Cohesion band?

A) It raises the band: lots of linking words.

B) No effect: linkers aren't marked.

C) It lowers the band: the linking is mechanical and overused.

2

An essay answers a different question from the one in the prompt, but it is well organized and grammatically excellent. Which criterion is most affected?

A) Task Response

B) Coherence & Cohesion

C) Grammatical Range & Accuracy

3

"Cities face heavy traffic, poor air quality and crowded trains." Which next sentence has the clearest cohesion?

A) Moreover, this makes it essential.

B) These pressures make government action essential.

C) Cities face heavy traffic, poor air quality and crowded trains, so government action is essential.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain what each of the four writing criteria rewards
- ◆ ☐ tell coherence from cohesion
- ◆ ☐ refer back with *this / these* + *summary noun* instead of repeating
- ◆ ☐ spot over-linking and repair it
- ◆ ☐ band-estimate a script with evidence, and find the criterion holding my own writing back

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write your four criterion estimates and the one holding you back. Then write the one change you will make in your next Task 2.

Speaking & Test Mastery

Three lessons and a final practice test. Learn to give the examiner enough to reward: longer answers, a full two-minute talk, and a real argument in Part 3. Find out how Speaking is marked, and lift your pronunciation and vocabulary. Then plan your test day, from the clock to the nerves, and take Practice Test 2 to see how far you've come.

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C12–C16

Target band 6.0–7.5

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Write**, **Listen**, **Say**, **Read** or **With a partner**. In Speaking there's rarely one right answer. What matters is that you give the examiner **enough English to reward**, clearly and naturally.

When a task asks about your own life, you decide what to share. Use your real life, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent. In the real test you can invent details too: you're marked on your English, not on your life.

◆ READ AND SAY — KEY VOCABULARY

the interview 11–14 minutes with an examiner	Part 1 familiar topics, 4–5 min	Part 2 / the long turn speak alone for 2 min	the cue card the topic + bullet points
the prep minute 1 minute to make notes	Part 3 abstract discussion, 4–5 min	to extend to make an answer longer	a filler words that buy thinking time
to speculate to talk about what might happen	to hedge to make a claim less absolute	a counter-view the other side of an argument	fluency speaking without long stops

The main reason is...

For instance,...

Unlike..., I...

I remember...

If I had more time, I'd...

I'd argue that...

That said,...

In the long run, I imagine...

Well, that's an interesting question...

Sorry, could you repeat that?

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

The three parts.

Part 1 • 4–5 min	familiar topics: home, work or study, free time, daily life	2–3 sentences per answer
Part 2 • 3–4 min	a cue card: 1 minute to make notes, then speak for up to 2 minutes	keep going until the examiner says "Thank you"
Part 3 • 4–5 min	general, abstract questions linked to the Part 2 topic	3–4 sentences: a small argument

Grow the answer. Do you like cooking?

Answer	Yes, I really do, especially on weekends,
Why	because it helps me switch off after work.
Example	Last Sunday, for instance, I made a huge pot of soup for my neighbors.
+ Contrast	Unlike my brother, who lives on takeout, I actually enjoy the chopping.

+ Experience	I remember burning the rice the very first time I tried.
+ Hypothetical	If I had more time, I'd take a proper cooking class.

Part 3: build a small argument. opinion → reason → other view → resolution → future

Opinion	I'd argue that... · Personally, I tend to think... · It depends largely on...
Reason	The main reason is that... · mainly because...
Other view	That said, ... · Some people would say..., but...
Resolution	So perhaps the answer is... · On balance, ...
Future	In the long run, I imagine... · It's likely that... will...

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: TWO CANDIDATES

Your teacher reads two candidates, Hana and Diego, answering the same four Part 1 questions. Who will score higher? Then listen to Diego again and tick (✓) the moves he uses.

Question	Answer	Why	Example	Contrast	Experience	Hypothetical
1 Do you work or study?						
2 Do you prefer mornings or evenings?						
3 Do you enjoy music?						
4 How do you usually travel around your city?						

Why will Hana probably score lower? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: GROW THE ANSWER

Each answer is too short. Rewrite it as a 2–3 sentence Part 1 answer: answer + why + example. Your life, a new identity, or invented details are all fine.

1. Do you enjoy walking? — "Yes."

→ _____

2. Do you prefer to study in the morning or in the evening? — "The evening."

→ _____

3. Is there a good park near where you live? — "No, not really."

→ _____

4. How often do you listen to music on your phone? — "Every day."

→ _____

5. Do you like rainy days? — "Not much."

→ _____

◆ READ — EXERCISE 3: MATCH THE MOVE

One candidate answered "Do you like rainy weather?" in six parts. Match each part (a–f) to the move (1–6).

1 Answer	_____	a) "Last Saturday, for instance, I spent the whole afternoon with a novel and a pot of tea."
2 Why	_____	b) "If I lived somewhere hot and dry, I think I'd actually miss it."
3 Example	_____	c) "Honestly, I quite like it,"
4 Contrast	_____	d) "I remember walking home in a storm as a teenager and laughing the whole way."
5 Experience	_____	e) "because it gives me an excuse to stay in and read."
6 Hypothetical	_____	f) "Unlike my sister, who gets really gloomy, I find it relaxing."

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 4: THE PREP MINUTE

You have **exactly 60 seconds**. Make keyword notes only (no full sentences) for this cue card. Add a personal angle and an ending.

CUE CARD

Describe a time you learned something new outside a classroom.

You should say:

what you learned · who helped you (if anyone) · how long it took
and explain how you felt about learning it.

What		Who	
How long		Feeling	
Personal angle			
My ending			

Now talk for two minutes to a partner from your notes only. Did you write any full sentences? _____

How long did you talk? _____

◆ READ — EXERCISE 5: ORDER THE PART 3 ANSWER

The examiner asks: "Do you think people will still read printed books in the future?" Put the answer in order: opinion → reason → other view → resolution → future.

- a) That said, I can see why e-readers appeal to people: you can carry hundreds of books in your pocket.
- b) I'd say yes, printed books will survive, although probably in smaller numbers.
- c) So perhaps the future isn't one or the other, but people choosing print for the books they really love.
- d) The main reason is that a lot of readers still enjoy the feel of paper and a break from screens.
- e) In the long run, I imagine printed books might even become a bit of a luxury, like vinyl records.

Order: _____ → _____ → _____ → _____ → _____

Now answer a different question aloud with the same five moves: "Should cities spend more money on parks?"

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: THE START OF THE TEST

Examiner: Good afternoon. My name is Ms. Rivera. Can you tell me your full name, please?

Leo: Good afternoon. It's Leonardo Costa, but everyone calls me Leo.

Examiner: Thank you. Now, in this first part, I'd like to ask you some questions about yourself. Do you work or are you a student?

Leo: I work, actually. I'm a lab assistant at a water-testing company. I check samples from the city's reservoirs, which sounds dull, but I find it surprisingly satisfying, because you can see exactly what you've achieved at the end of the day.

Examiner: Do you like the area where you live?

Leo: Mostly, yes. It's quite a close-knit neighborhood; people say hello in the street. The only drawback is the noise from the highway. If I could change one thing, I'd move that highway a mile away!

Examiner: Thank you. Now I'd like you to speak about a topic for up to two minutes. Here's your card. You have one minute to prepare first, and you can make notes.

Leo: Sorry, could I have something to write with?

Examiner: Of course. Here's some paper and a pencil. Your minute starts now.

Underline one example of each: a reason, a contrast, a hypothetical. Why is it fine for Leo to ask for something to write with?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – MOCK-EXAMINER TRIOS

Work in threes: **candidate**, **examiner** (reads the script and the cards) and **timekeeper** (times each part and takes notes). Change roles each round.

Part 1	1½ min	three questions from one card
Part 2	1 min + 2 min	keyword notes, then talk until "Thank you"; one short follow-up question
Part 3	2 min	two linked questions: opinion, reason, other view
Feedback	1½ min	the timekeeper gives one strength and one next step, with a quote

When I was the candidate: my Part 2 lasted _____ · one strength: _____ ·
one next step: _____

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

In Part 1 the examiner asks, "Do you like reading?" Which response gives you the best chance of a high fluency score?

A) "Yes, I do."

B) A long, rehearsed speech about the history of literature that you learned by heart.

C) "I love it, actually — it's how I switch off before bed. Lately I've been reading a lot of crime novels."

2

You get your Part 2 cue card and one minute to prepare. What's the best use of that minute?

A) Write out the whole answer word for word to read aloud.

B) Jot keywords for each bullet plus a personal angle, and plan how to fill two minutes.

C) Sit quietly and try to calm your nerves without writing anything.

3

In Part 3 the examiner asks, "Why do some people prefer to shop online?" Which answer is strongest?

A) "Because it's easy."

B) "I'd say convenience is the main reason: you can compare prices at midnight without leaving home. That said, some people still prefer stores because they want to see things first, so I suspect both will survive."

C) "I shop online every week. Yesterday I bought some shoes."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ describe the three parts of the Speaking test and their timing
- ◆ ☐ extend a Part 1 answer with answer + why + example (and contrast, experience or a hypothetical)
- ◆ ☐ use the prep minute for keyword notes and talk for the full two minutes
- ◆ ☐ answer a Part 3 question with an opinion, a reason and another view
- ◆ ☐ keep going with a filler instead of freezing, and ask for repetition politely

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write the shortest answer you gave today, then rewrite it as a fully extended one. Name the filler you'll use next time instead of stopping.

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY VOCABULARY

a criterion (plural: criteria)
one thing the examiner marks

coherence
ideas connected logically

lexical resource
your vocabulary: range + precision

accuracy
how few errors you make

intelligibility
how easy you are to understand

a chunk
a group of words said together

word stress
the strong syllable in a word

sentence stress
the strong words in a sentence

intonation
the voice going up ↗ or down ↘

a collocation
words that naturally go together

idiomatic
natural, fixed expressions

to paraphrase
to say it in other words

strike a balance

a heavy workload

pay close attention

a close-knit community

a daunting task

vividly remember

it's not really my cup of tea

I'm of two minds about it

it's grown on me

off the top of my head

◆ LANGUAGE BOX

The four Speaking criteria (each 25%), in our own words, paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors:

Fluency & Coherence	Do you keep going without long pauses, and are your ideas easy to follow?
Lexical Resource	How wide and precise is your vocabulary? Do you use some less common and idiomatic words naturally? Can you paraphrase?
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	Do you mix simple and complex sentences? How many errors, and do they block meaning?
Pronunciation	Are you easy to understand? Do you control stress, intonation and chunking? (Accent is not marked.)

Sound clear.

Chunks	What I love about it / is the sense of space / especially in the early morning.
Word stress	photograph · photography · photographic · economy · economic

Sentence stress	I didn't say she took it. (= someone else took it)
Intonation	Do you live nearby? ↗ · Where do you live? ↘ · reading ↗, cooking ↗ and hiking ↘

Sound precise.

good	rewarding · worthwhile · beneficial · impressive
nice	pleasant · welcoming · scenic · charming
bad	disappointing · harmful · unpleasant
thing	aspect · factor · feature · drawback
very + adjective	very tired → exhausted · very big → enormous · very interesting → fascinating
Can't find the word?	It's a kind of... · It's the thing you use to... · It's a bit like a... · I don't know the exact word, but...

One idiom used naturally is better than three forced ones. If you're not sure it fits, use a simpler word you control.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: SAME IDEA, TWO BANDS

Your teacher reads two versions of the same Part 2 talk about a market. Which one is higher? Why? Then listen to the second version again and complete the gaps.

"There's a little street market about ten minutes from my apartment, and it's become my (1) _____ place on Saturday mornings. It's a really (2) _____ spot: dozens of stalls, fresh fruit piled high, that sort of thing. I usually go with a couple of close friends; we grab a coffee, wander around and (3) _____ on the week. I (4) _____ remember the first time I went: I couldn't believe the (5) _____ of spices... After an hour there I feel completely (6) _____."

The speaker couldn't find one word and paraphrased it. What did they say? _____
What was the missing word? _____

◆ SAY – EXERCISE 2: WORD STRESS

Underline the stressed syllable. Then say each word to a partner.

1. photograph 2. photography 3. photographic 4. comfortable
5. economy 6. economic 7. environment 8. technology
9. development 10. necessary 11. interesting 12. vegetable

Three of these words usually lose a syllable in natural speech. Which ones? _____

◆ SAY – EXERCISE 3: CHUNKS AND ARROWS

A. Mark the chunks with / and circle the strongest word in each chunk. Then read aloud.

1. What I really enjoy about my job is the variety because no two days are ever the same.
2. When I was younger I hated vegetables but these days I actually grow my own.
3. Personally I think public transportation should be free for students and older people.

B. Rising ↗ or falling ↘? Draw an arrow at the end of each item.

4. Have you ever been there? _____
5. What time does it open? _____
6. I need bread _____, milk _____ and eggs _____. 7. Would you like tea _____ or coffee _____?

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: UPGRADE AND COLLOCATE

A. Rewrite each sentence with more precise words.

1. My new job is very good, but the work is a lot.
→ _____
2. The park near my apartment is nice and there are a lot of things to do.
→ _____
3. The movie was very bad and the ending was very strange.
→ _____
4. Online learning has some good things and some bad things.
→ _____

B. Complete the collocations.

5. strike a _____
6. a heavy _____
7. pay close _____
8. a close- _____ community
9. a _____ task (difficult and a little frightening)
10. _____ remember (in clear detail)
11. _____ a decision

C. Natural (N) or forced (F)? Write N or F.

12. "Horror movies aren't really my cup of tea, so I usually pick comedies." _____
13. "My grandmother is a real game-changer when she cooks rice." _____
14. "I didn't like the city at first, but it's grown on me." _____
15. "When the examiner asked me, I was over the moon and under the weather." _____

◆ SAY – EXERCISE 5: PARAPHRASE AROUND A GAP

Imagine you can't remember these words. Describe each one in one sentence so a listener understands. Use a frame: *It's a kind of...* · *It's the thing you use to...* · *It's the person who...*

1. a receipt → _____

2. a commute → _____
3. a landlord → _____
4. a microwave → _____

Read one to a partner without saying the word. Can they guess it?

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: AFTER THE RATING

Mina: OK, Tomás, I've got your bands. Want the good news first?

Tomás: Please. I'm a bit nervous about this.

Mina: Fluency, I'd say a 7. You kept going for the whole two minutes and you used "That said" really naturally.

Tomás: Really? It felt like I was rambling.

Mina: Not at all. Lexical Resource is more like a 6. You said "nice" three times, but "a heavy workload" was great.

Tomás: Fair enough. What about pronunciation?

Mina: Clear, easy to follow. Maybe a 6 or a 7. Your lists were a bit flat, though. Everything stayed at the same level.

Tomás: So the voice should go up, up, and then down at the end?

Mina: Exactly. And one target: swap "nice" for something more precise.

Tomás: OK. Let me try the first thirty seconds again.

How does Mina give her evidence? Underline one quote she uses for each criterion. Practice the dialogue, then use the same language when you rate a partner.

◆ WITH A PARTNER – BAND-ESTIMATION TRIOS

Work in threes: **candidate**, **examiner** and **rater**. The rater listens for quotes, then gives a whole band per criterion (or "6/7") using the Speaking band card, and one target. The candidate re-does the first 30 seconds with the target. These are **estimates**, not real scores.

Criterion	A quote I heard	Band
Fluency & Coherence		
Lexical Resource		
Grammatical Range & Accuracy		
Pronunciation		
One target		

1

Which best describes what the Pronunciation criterion rewards?

- A) Being clearly understood, with good use of stress, intonation and connected speech
- B) A British or American native accent
- C) Speaking as fast as possible

2

In the middle of an answer, you can't remember a word. What's the best move for your Lexical Resource band?

- A) Paraphrase: describe the word so the examiner understands
- B) Stop and stay silent until it comes to you
- C) Use a memorized idiom, even if it doesn't fit

3

Which sentence uses idiomatic language naturally?

- A) "My boss is a piece of cake, so the meeting was over the moon."
- B) "The questions were raining cats and dogs in my exam."
- C) "I used to find jazz a bit chaotic, but it's really grown on me."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ name the four Speaking criteria and say what each one rewards
- ◆ ☐ speak in chunks and stress the right syllable in common academic words
- ◆ ☐ use rising and falling intonation for questions, lists and closing a point
- ◆ ☐ replace over-used words with precise ones and use a collocation or idiom naturally
- ◆ ☐ paraphrase around a missing word, and estimate a partner's band with evidence

◆ MY NEW WORDS

Five words I over-use → a sharper word for each.

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Give yourself a band on each criterion with one line of evidence. Which one criterion will you target this

week, and how?

◆ READ AND SAY – KEY VOCABULARY

to register to book your test	ID (identification) passport or national ID card	the reporting time when you must arrive	an invigilator (a proctor) the person who supervises
the answer sheet where you write answers	to transfer to copy answers across	computer-delivered on a computer at a test center	paper-based with pencil and paper
the Test Report Form your official results	a remark a second marking of a section	to taper to do less before the test	a mock test a practice test under real timing

◆ READ – MY TOOLKIT: SOLID, SHAKY OR NOT YET?

Each lesson gave you one band-raising move. Tick one box for each.

Lesson • move	Solid	Shaky	Not yet
1.1 Know the format and timing; never leave a blank	☐	☐	☐
1.2 Recognize and produce paraphrase	☐	☐	☐
1.3 Wider grammar with accuracy	☐	☐	☐
2.1 Listening: predict the answer type; catch distractors	☐	☐	☐
2.2 Reading: skim, scan, find keywords	☐	☐	☐
2.3 True / False / Not Given and matching	☐	☐	☐
3.1 Task 1: a clear overview and accurate trend language	☐	☐	☐
3.2 Task 2: answer the question; develop each idea	☐	☐	☐
3.3 Link naturally; write to the four criteria	☐	☐	☐
4.1 Extend answers; a two-minute long turn	☐	☐	☐
4.2 Clear pronunciation; precise vocabulary	☐	☐	☐
4.3 A timing plan and a test-day plan	☐	☐	☐

Your timing plan.

Listening · about 30 min	4 parts, 40 questions · read ahead · predict · the recording is played once · never leave a blank
Reading · 60 min	3 passages, 40 questions · about 20 minutes each · no extra time to copy answers · guess and move on
Writing · 60 min	Task 1 about 20 min (150+ words) · Task 2 about 40 min (250+ words; worth more)
Speaking · 11–14 min	face to face with an examiner · extend every answer · ask for repetition if you need it

Planning language.

Plans	I'm taking the test on May 14. · I'm going to do a timed Reading every Tuesday.
If-then plans	If I miss a Listening answer, I'll go straight to the next one.
By test day	By the end of April, I'll have done two full timed mocks.
Time-buyers	That's an interesting question — let me think for a second. · Sorry, could you repeat that?

Computer or paper? The questions, timing and difficulty are the same, and Speaking is always with a person. On computer you type answers and see a word count. On paper you write on an answer sheet and estimate your own word count. Practice in the format you've booked, and read your test provider's official information for your own test.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THE TEST-DAY BRIEFING

Your teacher reads a test-day briefing. Complete the checklist.

- ☐ Bring the ID you (1) _____.
- ☐ Arrive well before the (2) _____.
- ☐ Water is usually allowed in a (3) _____ bottle.
- ☐ Your phone must be switched off and left in the (4) _____.
- ☐ Reading: about (5) _____ minutes per passage.
- ☐ Writing: about (6) _____ minutes on Task 2.

◆ READ – EXERCISE 2: SPOT THE TEST-DAY ERROR

Name the one habit that will lower each candidate's band, and say what they should do instead.

- In Reading, Ana spends 12 minutes on one hard matching question to "get it right."

2. In Speaking Part 2, Ben recites a memorized paragraph that only loosely fits the cue card.

3. In Listening, Carla misses question 14, panics, and misses 15 and 16 too.

4. In Writing, Dev writes 320 words for Task 1 and has 22 minutes left for Task 2.

5. In Speaking Part 3, Eun-ji doesn't understand one word in the question, so she says nothing.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: ORDER THE COUNTDOWN

You have four weeks. Write each activity in the right week.

(a) a full timed mock (b) drilling your weakest question type (c) light review of your error notes only (d) getting a Task 2 essay marked

Week 1 (earliest) _____ Week 2 _____ Week 3 _____ Week 4 (test week)

◆ READ – EXERCISE 4: DIAGNOSE THE PROFILE

Your overall band is the average of the four skills, rounded to the nearest half band (.25 rounds up to .5; .75 rounds up to the next whole band).

1. Karim needs **6.5 overall, with nothing below 6.0**. His mock: Listening 7.0 · Reading 7.0 · Writing 5.5 · Speaking 6.5.

Does he meet the requirement? _____ Where should he focus, and why?

2. Lucía needs **7.0 overall, with nothing below 6.5**. Her mock: Listening 7.0 · Reading 7.0 · Writing 6.5 · Speaking 6.5.

Her average: _____ → overall band _____. Does she meet the requirement? _____

What's the risk, and what should she do?

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: MY PLAN FOR THE DAY

A. My timing plan, in my own words.

Listening	
Reading	
Writing	
Speaking	

B. Three if-then plans for nerves and problems.

1. If _____, I'll _____.
2. If _____, I'll _____.
3. If _____, I'll _____.

◆ **READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: THE NIGHT BEFORE**

Sara: Right, let's check. Passport?

Kwame: In my bag. It's the one I registered with, so no surprises there.

Sara: Good. What time do you have to be there?

Kwame: The reporting time's 8:15, but I'm planning to arrive by 7:45 in case the bus is late.

Sara: Smart. Are you going to study tonight?

Kwame: Just ten minutes on my toolkit notes. I'm trying not to cram. I've done the work.

Sara: And if you blank in Speaking?

Kwame: Then I'll say, "That's an interesting question, let me think for a second," and give an opinion and a reason.

Sara: And if you miss an answer in Listening?

Kwame: The recording moves on, so do I. Honestly, I'm nervous, but it's the good kind.

Sara: That's the spirit. Now go to bed!

Find two if-then plans and one future plan in the dialogue. Which of Kwame's habits will you copy?

◆ **WITH A PARTNER – FULL SPEAKING MOCK**

Sit facing your partner, like in the test. The examiner uses the script. After your mock, your examiner tells you two bands (your strongest and weakest criterion) with evidence, and one target.

Part 1 · 3 min	Part 2 · 1 + 2 min	Part 3 · 4 min	Feedback · 2 min
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My strongest criterion: _____ · My weakest: _____ · My target: _____

◆ **WRITE – MY COUNTDOWN PLAN**

My test date: _____ · Format: computer / paper (circle) · Test center: _____

When (dates)	Priority	What I'll do each week	Feedback from
~8 weeks out	Build technique		

~4 weeks out	Apply under time		
~2 weeks out	Full rehearsals		
1 week out	Taper		
The day before	Rest		

If your test is sooner than eight weeks away, start at the row that fits and keep the taper and the rest.

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

On test morning, which single item is essential? Without it you cannot take the test.

A) A favorite pen

B) A bottle of water

C) The ID you registered with

2

Which technique appears in both Reading and Speaking (and beyond)?

A) Skimming for gist

B) Paraphrasing

C) Trend language

3

You believe your Writing score doesn't reflect how you performed. What can you do?

A) Email the examiner and ask them to change it.

B) Ask your test center for a remark (an "enquiry on results") within the allowed period.

C) Nothing. Scores can never be reviewed.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ rate my toolkit and choose where my revision hours go first
- ◆ ☐ state a timing plan for every paper

- ◆ ☐ say what to bring, what to leave and what to check on test day
- ◆ ☐ use two strategies for nerves and explain my results and remark options
- ◆ ☐ write a dated countdown plan that tapers before the test

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Finish this sentence honestly: "The one change with the biggest payoff for my band is ____, and this week I will ____."

BEFORE YOU READ YOUR NUMBERS

A practice band is a **snapshot, not a sentence**. The same person can score half a band higher or lower on a different day. Look at the **trend** across your three results. About half a band in eight weeks is a real gain. Compare yourself with **you**, not with anyone else.

◆ C15 EXIT SLIP

One thing that went better than Practice Test 1: _____

One thing to look at: _____

◆ MY BAND PROFILE

	Diagnostic (C1)	Practice Test 1 (C8)	Practice Test 2 (C15–C16)	My target
Listening				
Reading				
Writing			(to follow)	
Speaking				
Overall				

The skill that moved most: _____ · The skill that matters most for my target:

◆ WHERE DID MY MARKS GO?

For Listening and Reading, write a tally mark for every wrong answer in Practice Test 2, using your error codes from Module 2. Put a star next to any row that was also a problem in Practice Test 1.

Cause	Listening	Reading
D distractor (wrote the first / corrected-away answer)		—
S spelling or plural (L) · copied a word wrongly (R)		
W word limit / wrong form		
N number, letter or date misheard		—
L lost my place / froze		—

P missed the paraphrase		
M word-match trap (same words, different meaning)	—	
O looked in the wrong place	—	
T ran out of time / left a blank	—	
F confused False and Not Given	—	
K used own knowledge, not the text	—	
Q missed a qualifier (<i>all, some, only...</i>)	—	
H heading matched a detail, not the main idea	—	
X transfer error (right answer, wrong box / illegible)		
Other		

The question type I lost most marks on: _____

◆ MY NEXT-STEP PLAN

My target: overall _____, with no skill below _____ · My test date:

My gap: _____

The one change with the biggest payoff: _____

Three things I'll do every week:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Who will give me feedback on Writing and Speaking? _____

◆ SOMETHING I CAN DO NOW

One thing I can do now that I couldn't do in week 1.

◆ A MESSAGE TO MYSELF

Read it on the morning of your test.

